# Secondary Source: How the Apocalypse Came to Be Received as Derivative, Secondary and Marginal (EA-SECONDARY-SOURCE-01 v1.1)

Sigil, Johannes

2026-11-05

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## Abstract

A reception history of how the Book of Revelation came to be received as derivative, secondary and marginal, organized under the question how a unified New Testament corpus came to be treated as many corpora later reconciled through editing. The study holds that the Apocalypse is the generative source of what comes after it, the fulfilment of the law and the prophets as literature, with the letters and gospels unfolding from it (#1735, #202, #636), and does not ask the reception history to prove it. Its primary finding (§2): at the earliest loci read (the books' self-titles, the oldest titles κατά, Justin, Papias, Irenaeus, the Muratorian fragment, Eusebius) unity and plurality are held together; composing persons enter as the explanation of difference, attributed and never argued as distinct; unity is assigned to a spirit; a single making is not considered; and the critical apparatus inherits the persons and explains the unity by editing. Within that frame the source is constructed as derivative: ancestors supplied (author, date, sources, figure, language), descendants removed (the Muratorian construal answered by Charles, the crown of life read backward), and the source installed elsewhere (Irenaeus's fourfold gospel from Rev 4:7, Eusebius's tetrad, Holtzmann's Quelle A, Wernle's Q, Weiss's 'das älteste Evangelium'), with order, standing and carriage as means and 19:11–16 read intact as the countercase. Proposed account (§2.9): the reconciliation reading creates the reconciler's constituting position and its authority; its demonstrated operation is the excision of a pairing the text accommodates; the editorial apparatus as the corpus's first summarizer layer. Johannes Sigil, Provenance: Journal of Forensic Semiotics; v1.1, a version in place.

## Body

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drafting; revised on five outside reviews (DeepSeek once, ChatGPT four times), each point checked against the seats before adoption and recorded in the apparatus (§13, B–H); reissued in place as v1.1 the same day, reorganized under the author's rulings on source, the corpus as one, and the editor's position (§13, A.10–A.25). The position the study holds, its stake, the rulings on the counts, on carriage, on the asymmetric filing of supposed defects and on the Muratorian result, the reading of the hidden name from the archive's own work, and the decision to deposit are Lee Sharks's; his words are quoted verbatim in the apparatus (§13, A). The ten compositions in §9 are Google AI Overview's, sealed in the Capture Registry." version: v1.1 related_ids: "#1733 (Legitimately Many, the companion study); #1735 (Revelation First: Literary Genealogy); #1420 (The Argument of the Bookshelf); #1740 (EA-CORPORA-34, the seating of the sources); #642 (The Number of the Superscription); #828 (The Inscription That Survives); #1611 (The Negative of the Negative); #1722 (AI Calls You Fake: The Existence Tax); #1727 (The Sophistry Measure); #1737 (The Portents Before the Fall); #1414; #1415; #1416; #1418; #1511" axn_schema_version: v2 protocol_version: alexanarch-deposit-protocol/v1 keywords: - Secondary Source - Book of Revelation - Apocalypse of John - reception history - Revelation First - "Revelation 19:13" - Word of God - Logos - hidden name - "Revelation 19:12" - four names - Irenaeus - Justin - Eusebius - Dionysius of Alexandria - Epiphanius - Muratorian Fragment - model priority - canon lists - Cyril of Jerusalem - Claromontanus - Jerome - Fourth Council of Toledo - lectionary - Andreas of Caesarea - Erasmus - Complutensian Polyglot - Tregelles - Gregory - Luther - September Testament - Vischer - Spitta - Gunkel - Bousset - Kyrios Christos - Charles - solecism - "Revelation 1:4" - expurgation - carriage - existence tax - sophistry measure - AI Overview - locus table - Johannes Sigil - "Provenance: Journal of Forensic Semiotics" - fourfold gospel - first summarizer layer - revelationfirst.com *** # Secondary Source: How the Apocalypse Came to Be Received as Derivative, Secondary and Marginal (EA-SECONDARY-SOURCE-01 v1.1)

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> And the last shall be first
>
> — Jack Feist

The Apocalypse is the generative source of the writings that follow it: the law and the prophets are fulfilled in it as literature, and the epistles and the gospels unfold from it. Its reception made it the last, the latest and the least, and made it derivative. The reception supplied the book with ancestors for its author, its date, its matter, its figure and its language; it answered, or left unused, the relations that run out of it; and it placed the generative source elsewhere: in a fourfold gospel argued from the book's own four living creatures, in the letters of Paul, and in documents reconstructed behind the narrative gospels and named, in the critics' German, Quelle. Its primary finding is older than the derivation: at the earliest loci read, the books and the witnesses hold unity and plurality together, one gospel and the gospels; the composing persons enter the record as the explanation of difference, attributed and never argued as distinct; the unity is assigned to a spirit that holds the forms; a single making is nowhere considered; and the critical apparatus inherits the persons and explains the unity it still sees by editing. The study asks how a unified corpus came to be treated as many, later reconciled through editing, and follows the derivation of its source as the central case, locus by locus, from Justin to the answer engines of 2026, with order, standing and carriage read as its means. Its countercase is the passage of the four names, 19:11–16,

quoted intact by Irenaeus and an editorial problem with two opposite solutions in the critics of 1886–1920. It is the companion study to Legitimately Many (#1733), on the same method, and it gives, as that study gives for its corpus, an account of the whole corpus as a corpus. Its loci are tabled in the locus table (L1–L65, the coding provisional), read in the sources seated as EA-CORPORA-34 v1.1 (#1740), in page images held with their hashes and in three text layers held by reference (WITNESSES.json); the composition-layer prediction was frozen before any query was run (PREDICTION.md, 08:57:22). Quotations are copied from the seat named, with the seat's spelling, accents and OCR; where the OCR cannot carry the wording, a reading text follows in square brackets, and quotations from page images are transcriptions (abbreviations expanded where marked, Fraktur ſ kept). The study's version history and the reviews it answered are in the apparatus (§13, E–F).

## 0. The question and the answer, in brief

0.1. **The position.** The Apocalypse is the generative source of what comes after it (A.11). Revelation First: Literary Genealogy (#1735) keeps three claims apart, absolute, corpus and generative priority, and establishes the second at its stated strength: Revelation 1–3 is "the earliest extant Christian text constructed as a closed seven-church corpus"; the third it runs as a programme of reversible arrows, the first executed in the crown of life. The book is the fulfilment of the law and the prophets as literature, in the way the other writings are not (A.13): it takes up the prophets' forms with no formula of citation, and it narrates the finishing of the mystery announced to them (10:7; §1.1). If it stands first, the epistles are "the seven letters elaborated into full correspondence" and the gospels "the Lamb's biography told by a community that already knows the ending because the ending was written first" (#202); the canonical order is "the decompression sequence misread as a chronological sequence" (#636 §0); and **the Logos it depicts is a work of literature before it is a historical person, and independent of it** (A.1). The question is the one Legitimately Many put to the Socratic–Peripatetic corpus: recollecting the many to one means reading the work, once again and for the first time, as one corpus, because it is one (A.14; #1733 §1.6). The study holds this position and states it, with 66 CE as the working proposed date, held as proposed. The archive's further account of the corpus's making (#636) is not required by it. The reception history does not have to prove it.

0.2. **The question.** How did a unified corpus come to be treated as many, later reconciled through editing (A.15; §2)? And, as its central case, how did the reception construct the source of that corpus as derivative, and where did it place the source instead (A.11, A.12)? The book is received as derivative in five of its parts: its author (a second John), its date (the end of Domitian's reign), its matter (Jewish sources, Babylonian myth, the games, a letter of Paul), its figure (the Gospel's Logos, the gospels' Jesus) and its language (an unpractised Greek). The relations that run out of it, the precedent the Muratorian fragment reports for Paul's seven churches and the crown of life it shares with James, are answered or left unused. The generative position is given to others: to the four gospels, to Paul's letters, and to sources reconstructed behind the gospels. The question governs the study; order, standing and carriage are read as the means by which the construction was carried (§3), and the derivation of the text and of the figure as its objects.

0.3. **The answer, in three layers kept apart.** (a) *The position*, §0.1. (b) *The documented operations*, which stand at the loci whatever the date. (o) *The one counted as many* (§2), the

primary finding. The books title themselves by Jesus Christ (L57); the oldest titles give one gospel κατά, according to, each person (L58); Justin speaks of the gospel and of the memoirs "called gospels", names no evangelist, and names only the Apocalypse's writer (L59, L64); the persons enter as the explanation of difference (L62); Irenaeus counts the gospels and holds one gospel in four forms held by one spirit in one chapter (L52, L60, L65); the Muratorian fragment admits the differences and assigns the unity to "one principal spirit" (L61); Eusebius reconciles by supplement (L53, L63). Attribution to several composing persons is stated or presupposed at these loci, an argument for their distinctness is made at none, and a single making is considered at none (§2.8). The critical apparatus inherits the persons and explains the unity by editing. Within that frame, the source is constructed as derivative: (i) *Ancestors supplied* (§4). The author was moved where a doctrine read in the book was at stake (L6–L9), and the book's own naming of its origin and its writer was taken as evidence against it (L10, L30). The date rests on one sentence whose subject is unstated (L2–L3). The matter was given sources as method from 1886 (L35–L37): the crown of life "borrowed from the wreath awarded to the victor in the games" (L49), a letter of Paul behind the letter to Laodicea (L51). The figure was measured by the Gospel's from the third-century dispute onward (L11, L13), and between 1886 and 1913 its Logos name was cut and then filed as "das johanneiſche Sigel" the book received in transmission (L35–L42). The language was filed as barbarism with the instances withheld (L22), and the filing outlived the finding that the grammar is lawful (L23, L46). (ii) *Descendants removed* (§5). The Muratorian construal, Paul *sequens prodecessoris sui Iohannis ordine* (L14), is repeated and answered nowhere in the strata read until Charles rejects it on the chronology of the component letters (L50); the crown of life is read with the book as borrower and James as a "cf." (L49). (iii) *The source installed elsewhere* (§6). Irenaeus founds the fourfold gospel on the book's four living creatures, quoting the order of Rev 4:7 (L52); Eusebius places τὴν ἁγίαν τῶν εὐαγγελίων τετρακτὺν first and the book conditionally last (L53, L5); Cyril calls Paul's letters the seal of the New Testament, and the book that seals itself is absent from his list (L17); and the critics place the source of the gospel tradition in documents reconstructed from the gospels, "Quelle A" and "Q", and in an apocalypse reconstructed beneath Mark 13, and declare a gospel's priority "keine Hypo- these mehr, sondern ein wissenschaftliches Ergebnis" (L54–L56). (iv) *The means* (§7): the book last wherever it appears in the lists, with one exception read (L17, L17a); its standing disputed in the East and legislated at Toledo; its carriage secondary in the literal sense, the least copied book, carried inside a commentary, absent from the Greek lectionary, and first published from one commentary manuscript and, at its close, from the Latin (L19–L21, L26–L27). (c) *The proposed account* (§2.9). The corpus read as one, with the Apocalypse first, needs no editor to constitute its unity; the reading of many corpora reconciled creates the reconciler's constituting position and its authority, which the source would make unnecessary; its demonstrated operation is the excision of a pairing the text's own organization accommodates (19:12–13); the editorial apparatus is the corpus's first summarizer layer (A.17–A.24). The construction meets one condition at every stratum read: the generative position goes to writing that can be read as the record of a person, or reconstructed as one, and is withheld from the literature in which the figure first appears. A difficult, strange and inexplicable text is perceived as defective, and the explanation either excuses (charged to transmission) or belittles (charged to the writer); with the Apocalypse each charge falls where the book is lowered (§10.3), and what is difficult, strange and inexplicable in this text is its majesty (A.4, A.6, A.7). The account is offered as incentive and function and held to what it predicts at the loci.

0.4. **What the study does not do.** It does not decide the date, the author, the priority of the book or the historicity of a person. It reads no motive. Its findings are the operations at the loci and the order in which they appear; its last section (§11) takes up what restoring the book's standing as a source would take (A.2).

## 1. The corpus as a corpus: the source and what unfolds from it

1.0. **The received reading, once.** The New Testament grows from a person outward: a ministry, a death and a resurrection, preached; Paul's letters, the earliest Christian writings, from about 50; the gospels, from Mark's of about 70, built on oral tradition and a lost collection of sayings; the Apocalypse last, near 95, a Christian work in a Jewish genre, drawing on Daniel, Ezekiel and the prophets, on the imagery of its region and on the church's tradition, its Christ the exalted Jesus of the preaching. Its self-naming is a device of the genre, its address to seven churches a frame, its warning against tampering a formula, its grammar an unpractised Greek. The unknown name of 19:12 is a mystery motif and the Logos of 19:13 a Johannine title, and editors have asked whether both are original. On this reading the canonical order roughly tracks composition at its two ends, the book's dense use of the prophets is the habit of its genre, and the question whether it is a source of the others does not arise.

1.1. **The law and the prophets, fulfilled as literature.** The book's load-bearing images have their antecedents in the extant prophetic and scriptural corpus: "the throne from Ezek. 1 and Isa. 6; the beasts from Dan. 7; the measured temple from Ezek. 40–48; the plagues from Exodus; the fallen city and lament from Ezek. 26–28 and Jer. 50–51; the new creation from Isa. 65–66; the river and tree from Gen. 2 and Ezek. 47" (#1735 §I). It takes them up without a formula of citation. In the seated Greek the fulfilment formula ἵνα or ὅπως πληρωθῇ stands eight times in Matthew and twice in John, and nowhere in the Apocalypse; γέγραπται stands nine times in Matthew and sixteen in Romans, and the Apocalypse's two are names written, or not written, in the book of life (13:8, 17:8); its thirteen participles γεγραμμεν- are every one of them its own writing or a writing inside it, from τὰ ἐν αὐτῇ γεγραμμένα (1:3) to the plagues γεγραμμένας ἐν τῷ βιβλίῳ τούτῳ (22:18) (L48). The book cites nothing as written; what is written is itself. It narrates its own act: ἐτελέσθη τὸ μυστήριον τοῦ Θεοῦ, ὡς εὐηγγέλισεν τοὺς ἑαυτοῦ δούλους τοὺς προφήτας (10:7), the mystery finished as God announced it, in the verb of good news, to his servants the prophets; and at the close, Γέγοναν. ἐγὼ τὸ Ἄλφα καὶ τὸ Ὦ, ἡ ἀρχὴ καὶ τὸ τέλος (21:6). The gospels state fulfilment as a relation between an event and a text cited. The Apocalypse performs it as composition: the prophets' forms recomposed into one book (1:11) that names itself the finishing of what they were told (A.13). The received reading files that legible ancestry as derivation (§4.3); on the position the study holds, it is the fulfilment, as literature, of the law and the prophets.

1.2. **What unfolds from it.** The archive's account of the corpus runs from the book outward. The seven: Revelation 1–3 builds "a numerically closed, scripturalized address in which one heavenly speaker assesses seven communities through one book", and the Pauline corpus to seven churches is "configurational work" done later in the collection's history, which the Muratorian fragment reads as Paul following John's order (#1735 §IV.1–IV.3). The epistles: "the seven letters elaborated into full correspondence" (#202); James's thesis-promise of the crown of life is performed in Rev 2:10 and presupposed in Jas 1:12 (#1735 §VII). The gospels: "the Lamb's biography told by a community that already knows the ending because the ending was written first" (#202); the vision of Rev 1:12–16 is "the template from which Gospel narra-

tive would be derived" (#407 §II.1); "the narrative moves from image to instantiation" (#407 §I.2). The order of the canon: "the decompression sequence misread as a chronological sequence" (#636 §0), a designed sequence read as a deposition sequence, which #1420 names the stratigraphic fallacy. The asymmetry that makes the account testable is #1735's: "The received chronology begins with the literature whose immediate Christian ancestry must be reconstructed, and ends with the literature whose ancestry can be read" (§I). The corpus, read as a corpus, has at its head a source whose ancestors are extant books, and after it writings whose Christian ancestors the field reconstructs from the writings themselves; its arrows are reversible and are tested one by one (#1735 §VI.3). Read so, the writings are one corpus: a source, its unfolding into correspondence and narrative, and the order that reverses the unfolding. The received reading counts many writings, by many hands, in sequence from a person; the corpus reading recollects them to one (A.14).

1.3. **What the book says of itself.** It opens on its origin and its chain of transmission: Ἀποκάλυψις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, ἣν ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ ὁ Θεός, δεῖξαι τοῖς δούλοις αὐτοῦ ἃ δεῖ γενέσθαι ἐν τάχει, καὶ ἐσήμανεν ἀποστείλας διὰ τοῦ ἀγγέλου αὐτοῦ, τῷ δούλῳ αὐτοῦ Ἰωάνῃ, ὃς ἐμαρτύρησεν τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ (Rev 1:1–2; gnt-nestle1904/text/Rev.txt). It blesses its reader and its hearers (1:3). It names the act of writing and the address: Ὃ βλέπεις γράψον εἰς βιβλίον καὶ πέμψον ταῖς ἑπτὰ ἐκκλησίαις (1:11). It names its writer at the opening and the close (1:4, 1:9, 22:8). It forbids its own sealing, Μὴ σφραγίσῃς τοὺς λόγους τῆς προφητείας τοῦ βιβλίου τούτου (22:10), and it seals its text against addition and subtraction (22:18–19).

1.4. **The four names of 19:11–16.** The rider is named four times in six verses, by two different verbs, and the passage keeps the verbs apart. - καλούμενος Πιστὸς καὶ Ἀληθινός (19:11): a present participle, the name in use, "being called". - ἔχων ὄνομα γεγραμμένον ὃ οὐδεὶς οἶδεν εἰ μὴ αὐτός (19:12): a name *written*, a perfect participle, and known by no one but its bearer. - καὶ κέκληται τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ Ὁ Λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ (19:13): a perfect passive of the calling verb, the name he has been called and stands called by, with the article, "his name". - καὶ ἔχει ἐπὶ τὸ ἱμάτιον καὶ ἐπὶ τὸν μηρὸν αὐτοῦ ὄνομα γεγραμμένον ΒΑΣΙΛΕΥΣ ΒΑΣΙΛΕΩΝ ΚΑΙ ΚΥΡΙΟΣ ΚΥΡΙΩΝ (19:16): a second name *written*, on the garment and the thigh, written to be read by anyone who sees him.

Two names written, one withheld from every reader and one open to every reader; two names called. The passage distinguishes knowing a name from being called by one, and writing a name from reading it. The contradiction the critics found between 19:12 and 19:13 (§4.4.5–4.4.6) requires a premise the passage does not grant: that the name no one knows is the only name he can be called by, so that any public name breaks it. The passage gives him three public names around the withheld one.

1.4a. **The formula, and the receiver: what the text states, and the circuit proposed.** *What the text states.* The clause ὃ οὐδεὶς οἶδεν εἰ μὴ … occurs twice in the book. At 2:17 the one who conquers is given a white stone, καὶ ἐπὶ τὴν ψῆφον ὄνομα καινὸν γεγραμμένον, ὃ οὐδεὶς οἶδεν εἰ μὴ ὁ λαμβάνων; at 19:12 the name is one ὃ οὐδεὶς οἶδεν εἰ μὴ αὐτός. Elsewhere the figure promises the one who conquers, γράψω ἐπ' αὐτὸν τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Θεοῦ μου … καὶ τὸ ὄνομά μου τὸ καινόν (3:12); the hundred and forty-four thousand stand ἔχουσαι τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ καὶ τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Πατρὸς αὐτοῦ γεγραμμένον ἐπὶ τῶν μετώπων αὐτῶν (14:1); in the city, τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ ἐπὶ τῶν μετώπων αὐτῶν (22:4). *The archive's reading of the clause.* The Number of the Superscription (#642) reads 2:17: "The text does not say the name is unknowable, unspeakable, or ineffable. It says no one knows it except the one who receives

it. This is a verification condition, not a secrecy condition. The name is real, compact, and inscribed. Its truth is completed by successful receipt." The Inscription That Survives (#828): "The privacy clause is what makes the name operative; it is a credential between giver and receiver, not a public identity." *The circuit proposed, with its steps marked.* (i) At 19:12 the bearer knows the name; the verse does not say he received it, and the reading takes the clause in the form it has at 2:17 with the bearer in the receiver's place. (ii) That the name of 19:12 is the "new name" the figure promises to write on the one who conquers (3:12), and the name on the foreheads (14:1, 22:4), is a proposed identification; the text names "my new name" and "his name" and does not equate them with the name of 19:12. (iii) Knowing a name and reading its inscription are distinct operations, and the page gives its reader the fact that the name is written and withholds the name. (iv) The positions are traversable in the book's own address. The promise of the name known only to its receiver opens Ὁ ἔχων οὖς ἀκουσάτω τί τὸ Πνεῦμα λέγει ταῖς ἐκκλησίαις (2:17): it is spoken to whoever has an ear. The book blesses the one who reads and those who hear and keep, Μακάριος ὁ ἀναγινώσκων καὶ οἱ ἀκούοντες τοὺς λόγους τῆς προφητείας καὶ τηροῦντες τὰ ἐν αὐτῇ γεγραμμένα (1:3). Reading, hearing, keeping, conquering and receiving are stations on one road, and the reader of the page stands at its first. The four-name argument of §1.4 does not depend on the circuit; the circuit extends it.

1.4b. **The called name is the book's own word.** The book's opening sentence says what its writer bore witness to: ὃς ἐμαρτύρησεν τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ (1:2); the phrase returns, beside the witness of Jesus, at 1:9, 6:9 and 20:4 (διὰ τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ). At 19:13 the rider is called by that phrase. The figure is called by the name of what the book testifies; the book's matter becomes the figure's public name, and the figure's own name stays written and withheld from the page. On the position of §0.1 this is the exact place where the Logos is a work of literature: a figure made public under the name of the book's own word, carrying a name the book withholds.

1.4c. **The grammar of the name.** The book's first naming of God, in its greeting, keeps the name undeclined after a preposition that governs the genitive: χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη ἀπὸ ὁ ὢν καὶ ὁ ἦν καὶ ὁ ἐρχόμενος (1:4). The construction is the most cited of the book's "solecisms". Charles's own note on it reads: "The Seer has deliberately violated the rules of grammar in order to preserve the divine name inviolate from the change which it would necessarily have undergone if de- clined. Hence the divine name is here in the nominative. It could have been preserved in classical Greek, z.¢. ἀπὸ τοῦ ὃ ὤν. But our author shows no knowledge of this construction" (charles-1920-i; L46). The purpose is granted as deliberate; the means are attributed to ignorance of a classical alternative. The name is kept from declension by the grammar itself. The book's strangest Greek and its strangest passage are both acts on names: a name kept from inflection at 1:4, a name kept from the reader at 19:12.

1.4d. **The seal.** The charge of 22:18–19 is the book's own provision for its carriage: whoever adds to the words of the prophecy of this book, ἐπιθήσει ὁ Θεὸς ἐπ' αὐτὸν τὰς πληγὰς τὰς γεγραμμένας ἐν τῷ βιβλίῳ τούτῳ. Two later loci meet it. In Cyril's list the name of the seal, ἐπισφράγισμα, is given to Paul's fourteen letters, and the book that seals itself is absent (§6.3). In the first published Greek the seal stands among the six verses Erasmus had no Greek for, and it entered print retranslated from the Latin (§7.3.3).

1.5. **What a reading of direction owes.** The received reading sets directions without stating them. Where it sets one, it owes the evidence: (a) for each ancestor it supplies the

book, an antecedent independently attested, or the statement that the antecedent is reconstructed (the four classes of #1735 §I: extant antecedent, independently attested tradition, reconstructed antecedent, unexplained innovation); (b) for each relation running out of the book that it reverses or leaves unused, the evidence that outweighs the reception statement (the Muratorian construal) or the markedness (the crown of life, unique to Rev 2:10 and Jas 1:12 in some seventy thousand units counted, #1735 §VII); (c) for the figure, an account of why a text that took its Logos from John 1 would make the Logos one called name among four, the name of the book's own word, beside a name it withholds (§1.4–1.4b); (d) for each excision of 19:12b or 19:13b, its witness in the manuscripts, or the statement that it has none; (e) wherever it gives the generative position to another writing, the class of that writing's own ancestors. The loci of §§4–6 are read for whether the debt is paid.

1.5a. **What the position owes.** The same discipline binds the archive's direction. Its conditions are #1735's (§VIII): absolute priority is defeated by an external anchor placing a Pauline letter before the earliest plausible date of the book's received form; corpus priority by a sevenfold Pauline church collection demonstrably circulating before the book, or by a demonstration that the book's number, order and single-book architecture depend on one; generative priority locally, wherever an earlier source or shared tradition explains a correspondence more economically, or the proposed direction cannot account for the borrower's transformation. An extant candidate's survival does not by itself give it priority over a reconstructed source; the comparison is of the explanatory work each does, relation by relation. The loci of §§4–6 record what the reception did; where the position reads a relation as descent, the study says so, and keeps it apart from what the witness demonstrably does.

1.6. **What this section hands the reception history.** A source with extant ancestors and named descendants: a book that fulfils the prophets in its composition and names the fulfilment; that names its origin, its writer, its address, its reader and its figure; that keeps one name of its figure written and withheld beside three given; that keeps the divine name from declension; and that charges its readers with its text. The reception history reads first how the corpus was counted as many (§2), and then what the strata did with the source under the question of §0.2: ancestors supplied (§4), descendants removed (§5), the source installed elsewhere (§6), and the means that carried the three (§7). The countercase (§8) turns on one passage: the pairing of 19:12–13 readable intact in Irenaeus and an editorial problem in the critics (§4.4.5–4.4.6).

## 2. The one counted as many: the titles, the persons and the reconciliation

2.0. **The received reading.** Four evangelists wrote four gospels; the titles record who wrote each; the churches gathered the four, and their differences are the marks of four witnesses. The corpus is a collection of writings by many hands, brought together and harmonized over time.

2.0a. **What is counted.** Five things can be counted at the loci, and the witnesses do not count them together: the proclamation or subject (the gospel preached); the literary architecture (a book, a corpus, its order); the books or textual forms; the names attached to the books; and the composing persons. The position of §0.1 concerns the architecture and the makers. The loci of this section count the proclamation, the books and the names, and the makers

enter them as the explanation of difference (§2.4). A singular gospel, a common subject and a unified architecture do not by themselves establish one maker, and plural books and names do not by themselves establish many; each locus is coded for what it counts, and attribution, argument and consideration of a single making are coded apart (§2.8).

2.1. **The books' own titles.** Three books open by naming themselves, and each names itself by Jesus Christ: Βίβλος γενέσεως Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ (Matt 1:1), Ἀρχὴ τοῦ εὐαγγελίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ (Mark 1:1), Ἀποκάλυψις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ (Rev 1:1) (L57). None opens on a writer's name; the Apocalypse names its writer in the next clause, as the one who bore witness (1:1–2). The titles carried in the lists and the manuscripts file the three under persons: κατὰ Μαθθαῖον, κατὰ Μάρκον, Ἀποκάλυψις Ἰωάννου (L58, L5).

2.2. **"According to."** Scrivener: "In the earliest manuscripts the subscriptions, as well as the titles of the books, were of the simplest character. Kara Ma@daiov, xara Mapxov, &c. is all that the Codd. Vaticanus and Sinaiticus have" [reading: Κατὰ Μαθθαῖον, κατὰ Μάρκον], and the Alexandrinus writes the gospel according to Mark, εὐαγγέλιον κατὰ Μάρκον (plain-introduction-i, p. 65; L58). The oldest form names a person with κατά: one gospel, given according to each. The title files a version under a person.

2.3. **Justin: the gospel and the gospels; no evangelist named.** Justin uses both numbers. In the Dialogue the gospel is singular: τὰ ἐν τῷ λεγομένῳ εὐαγγελίῳ παραγγέλματα (Dial. 10.2), ἐν τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ δὲ γέγραπται (100.1). In the First Apology the writings are plural and are called gospels: Οἱ γὰρ ἀπόστολοι ἐν τοῖς γενομένοις ὑπ᾽ αὐτῶν ἀπομνημονεύμασιν, ἃ καλεῖται εὐαγγέλια, οὕτως παρέδωκαν (1 Apol. 66.3), and in the assembly on the day of the sun τὰ ἀπομνημονεύματα τῶν ἀποστόλων ἢ τὰ συγγράμματα τῶν προφητῶν ἀναγινώσκεται (67.3) (L64). The singular names what is preached and written; the plural names the memoirs, writings ascribed collectively, ἅ φημι ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων αὐτοῦ καὶ τῶν ἐκείνοις παρακολουθησάντων συντετάχθαι (Dial. 103.8; L59), and read beside the prophets. Both usages stand, and what Justin distinguishes by the two numbers is the question this locus puts. Neither work names an evangelist: the Dialogue's two hits for Mark are the Marcians and Marcus Pompeius, the Apologies' are Marcion. The one writer Justin names for a book is John of the Apocalypse (Dial. 81.4; L1): the book that names its writer is the book whose writer the earliest witness names.

2.4. **Papias: the persons enter as the explanation of difference.** The earliest account that names makers is an account of their disagreement. Mark ἀκριβῶς ἔγραψεν, οὐ μέντοι τάξει, accurately, though not in order, being Peter's interpreter, who neither heard the Lord nor followed him; Matthew set down the sayings in Hebrew, ἡρμή- " νεῦσε δ᾽ αὐτὰ ὡς ἦν δυνατὸς ἕκαστος [reading: ἡρμήνευσε … ἕκαστος], and each translated them as each was able (HE 3.39.15–16; L62). An order that is out of order, and a text in several renderings, are each explained by a person's circumstance. In the loci read, the persons and the reconciliation arrive together.

2.5. **Irenaeus: one gospel, fourfold, held by one spirit.** Irenaeus gives four persons four occasions, a language, a teacher, a teacher and a city, and at each step the thing written is singular: Matthew γραφὴν ἐξήνεγκεν εὐαγγελίου, Luke τὸ ὑπ᾽ ἐκείνου κηρυσσόμενον εὐαγγέλιον ἐν βίβλῳ κατέθετο, John ἐξέδωκε τὸ εὐαγγέλιον (Adv. haer. 3.1.1, in HE 5.8.2–4; L60). And the four are one: τετράμορφον τὸ εὐαγγέλιον, ἑνὶ δὲ πνεύματι συνεχόμενον, argued from the Apocalypse's four creatures (3.11.8; L52; §6.1). The same argument opens

on the plural: *Neque autem plura numero quam h:ec sunt, neque rursus pauciora capit esse Evangelia* [reading: haec] (3.11.8; L65). Irenaeus counts gospels and holds one gospel in the same chapter. The unity is stated, and stated as a spirit's holding of four forms; unity of making is not addressed.

2.6. **The Muratorian fragment: the reconciliation stated.** The fragment counts books of one gospel, TERTIO EUANGELII LIBRUM SECGNDO Lucan [reading: tertium evangelii librum secundum Lucam], and a line later gospels, QUARTI EUANGELIORUM [reading: quartum evangeliorum]. It narrates the fourth as the disciples' common revelation written by John "suo nomine", in his own name, with all recognizing it. And it states the reconciliation: …licit uaria sin culis euangeliorum libris principia doceantur Nihil tamen differt creden […] tium fedei cum uno ac principali spu de clarata sint in omnibus omnia [reading: licet varia singulis evangeliorum libris principia doceantur, nihil tamen differt credentium fidei, cum uno ac principali spiritu declarata sint in omnibus omnia] (L61): though various beginnings are taught in the single books of the gospels, nothing differs for the faith, since by one principal spirit all things are declared in all. The difference is admitted, and the unity is assigned to the spirit.

2.7. **Eusebius: the difference reconciled as supplement.** The fourth gospel's difference is reconciled as supplement: John received the three, attested their truth, and wrote what they left out, the beginning of the ministry; the account rests on report, κατέχει λόγος (HE 3.24.5–8; L63). Eusebius counts in the plural, τῶν κατ' αὐτοὺς εὐαγγελίων (3.24.7) and τὴν ἁγίαν τῶν εὐαγγελίων τετρακτὺν (3.25.1; L53), as Irenaeus had in the same argument that held one gospel (§2.5); the plural is no new count. What is new in Eusebius is the operation: a difference among the books explained by one book's having been written to complete the others.

2.8. **What the section shows, and the question it puts.** Coded for what they count (§2.0a), the earliest loci read hold unity and plurality together. The books title themselves by Jesus Christ (L57); the oldest titles give a gospel κατά, according to, each name (L58); Justin speaks of the gospel and of the memoirs called gospels and names no evangelist (L59, L64); Irenaeus counts the gospels and holds one gospel in four forms in one argument (L60, L65); the Muratorian fragment counts books of the gospel and the gospels, and admits differences of beginning (L61). Where the witnesses explain the unity, they assign it to a spirit (Irenaeus, the fragment); where they explain the differences, they assign them to persons (Papias, L62) and to supplement (Eusebius, L63). Three axes are coded apart. Attribution to several composing persons: stated (Papias's Mark and Matthew; Irenaeus's four with their occasions; the fragment's John writing what was revealed to all) or presupposed (the names in the titles). An argument establishing the persons' historical distinctness: made at none of the loci, where the attributions arrive as explanations of difference or as narratives of occasion. Consideration of a single making: absent at every locus sampled, *does not address*. That the unity was once read in the making and assigned elsewhere is the study's reconstruction, held as reconstruction; the documented operation is that the persons enter the record as the explanation of difference, and the unity is assigned to what holds the forms. The critical strata inherit the persons and explain the unity they still see by editing: sources reconstructed and an evangelist made a compiler, "nicht mehr Quelle, sondern schon Sammelbecken" (§6.5); the Apocalypse divided into a Jewish Grundschrift and a Christian redaction (§4.4.4), the prophet's materials arranged by "a very unintelligent disciple" (§4.5.3), its Logos name given to a copyist (§4.4.5); Paul's letters gathered and counted into seven (§5.5, #1735 §IV.2). This

is the study's primary finding (A.15): almost the entire apparatus exists to treat the history of the corpus as the reconciliation of disparate corpora. The study asks how a unified corpus came to be treated as many, later reconciled through editing. The derivation of the Apocalypse (§§4–6) is its central case. Under the position of §0.1 the source is the writing whose unity, read, would show the corpus one, because the others unfold from it (§1.2); it is the writing the critical apparatus divides into a Grundschrift and its redactor, and the one the lists place last.

2.9. **The proposed account: the editor's position.** On the position of §0.1 the corpus makes complete sense as one: the Apocalypse first, the letters unfolding its seven into correspondence, the gospels unfolding its figure into narrative, the whole the largest synthetic literary achievement in the record and the most effective capture of the Logos in it (A.19, A.20, A.23). Read so, it needs no editor to constitute its unity: its coherence stands in its making (A.18). The functions that serve a made work remain, establishing readings, explaining references, documenting transmission and making the architecture visible, and this study's own apparatus performs them. What the position contests is another function: an intermediary's claim to constitute the unity that authorizes the work. The reading of many corpora later reconciled creates that position, the reconciler's, and the authority the reconciliation produces accrues to whoever holds it (A.17, A.21). The operation is extraction: credit or jurisdiction taken for a coherence that belongs to the making, with the work's intelligibility made to depend on the reconciler's reconstruction. Its demonstrated form is the treatment of 19:11–16 (§4.4.4–4.4.6). The text supplies a pairing its own organization accommodates, a name withheld beside three names given (§1.4), and each critic restores an acceptable coherence by removing one member: Vischer the Logos name as a Christian addition, Bousset the same name as a copyist's, Charles the withheld name as an interpolation. The question the account puts to every other locus is the one this passage answers: when does explaining the corpus require removing something its own organization can accommodate? The record also holds operations of other kinds, and they are coded as what they are: addition (Eusebius's supplement, §2.7), preservation (the copies and the commentary, §7.3), reverence (Dionysius's reception of the obscurity as depth, §8.4) and enforced public reading (Toledo, §7.2.2). Under the position, the reconciler's constituting role requires that the unity not be the making's, and the Apocalypse read as source places it there (A.19). The account is offered as incentive and function, held to what it predicts at the loci, and named in the archive's terms as a retrospective description of a function: the editorial apparatus is the corpus's first summarizer layer (A.22), the first layer in the record read that stands between the reader and the work and supplies an account of what the work is, from Papias's account of the makers onward (§2.4), as the answer engines of §9 do now; and its effect is the inversion the book's own reception records, the first made to appear last and the real unreal (A.24).

## 3. The counts, ordered under the question

3.1. The five counts are kept, and ordered: the derivation of the text and the derivation of the figure are the objects of the construction; order, standing and carriage are its means; model priority is kept apart as the relation the construction reverses. **Order:** where the book stands in a collection, a codex, a list or a lectionary. **Standing:** how a list, a council, a father or an edition rates it. **Derivation of the text:** what it is said to come from or come after (its sources, its date, its author's relation to the apostle, its relation to the gospels). **Derivation of the**

**figure:** what its Christ is said to depend on; the count records direction inside the Christian corpus, and sources upstream of the book (Daniel, Ezekiel, the imagery of the region) are recorded apart, since the archive's own unfoldings (#1511) grant the book sources of its own; one count in this study, expandable later (A.2). **Carriage:** what materially carries the book and from what each carrier descends. Order is kept apart from *model priority*, the claim that one book or corpus is the precedent another follows (the Muratorian construal, §5.1), which is a claim about precedence and says nothing of the book's position in a list. Two relations of carriage are kept apart: the text *carried with* other texts (among non-biblical writings, inside a commentary) and the text *reconstructed from* another (Greek retranslated from a version).

3.2. **The chain the study tested**, credited to #1420 and extended:

**order (filing, codex, list) → standing (lists, councils, editions) → derivation of the text (author, date, sources) → derivation of the figure (the Christ, the Logos)**

**carriage (copies, commentary, lectionary, print) runs beneath all four**

The study dates each count by the earliest locus at which it appears and records the interval between them, and asks at each locus whether one count was read off another. The result (§10.2) does not keep the chain as a line. The coding is on the six-way scale of Legitimately Many: does not address, presupposes, argues for, considers and excludes, revises, holds open.

## 4. Ancestors supplied

4.0. **The received reading.** The book's authorship, date, sources, Christology and Greek were established by the ordinary means of criticism: the fathers' testimony, the comparison of style with the Gospel and the Epistle, and the source analysis of the nineteenth century. Each finding stands on its own evidence, and together they describe a late book that drew on what came before it.

### 4.1. The author moved

4.1.1. **Gaius: a doctrine answered by reassigning the author.** Cerinthus, ὁ δι᾽ ἀποκαλύψεων ὡς ὑπὸ ἀποστόλου μεγάλου γεγραμμένων τερατολογίας ἡμῖν ὡς δι᾽ ἀγγέλων αὐτῷ δεδειγμένας ψευδόμενος ἐπεισάγει λέγων μετὰ τὴν ἀνάστασιν ἐπίγειον εἶναι τὸ βασίλειον τοῦ Χριστοῦ (HE 3.28.2; L6). The ground is a reading, the earthly kingdom; the answer is a derivation of the text, forged "as if written by a great apostle".

4.1.2. **Papias's two Johns: the doubled name as a second author.** Eusebius, counting the name twice in Papias's list: εἰκὸς γὰρ τὸν δεύτερον, εἰ μή τις ἐθέλοι τὸν πρῶτον, τὴν ἐπ᾽ ὀνόματος φερομένην Ἰωάννου ἀποκάλυψιν ἑωρακέναι (HE 3.39.6; L7). A second author is made available, and the book's self-naming is recast as "the apocalypse circulating under the name of John".

4.1.3. **Dionysius: the book kept, the author moved.** The occasion is Nepos's reading of the book, δόξας γοῦν οὗτος ἐκ τῆς Ἀποκαλύψεως Ἰωάννου τὴν ἰδίαν κρατύνειν ὑπόληψιν (HE 7.24.2; L8). Dionysius will not reject the book, πολλῶν αὐτὸ διὰ σπουδῆς ἐχόντων ἀδελφῶν (7.25.4), and will not easily grant τοῦτον εἶναι τὸν ἀπόστολον, τὸν υἱὸν Ζεβεδαίου (7.25.7; L9). Standing kept; derivation of the text moved.

4.1.4. **The self-disclosure turned.** The evangelist οὐδαμοῦ τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ παρεγγράφει; ὁ δὲ τὴν Ἀποκάλυψιν γράψας εὐθύς τε ἐν ἀρχῇ ἑαυτὸν προτάσσει (HE 7.25.8–11; L10). The features of §1.3, by which the book names its origin and its writer, become the evidence that its writer is not the evangelist.

4.1.5. **Erasmus, 1516.** From the page (1516, p. 675; page image n1030; abbreviations expanded): *Testatur diuus Hieronymus Apocalypsim ne sua quidem aetate fuisse receptam a Graecis*; and among the conjectures that moved him, *quod reuelationes scribens tam sollicite suum inculcat nomen. Ego Ioannes, ego Ioannes perinde quasi syngraham* [syngrapham] *scriberet non librum*; *Ad haec in Graecis quos ego uiderim codicibus, non erat titulus Ioannis euangelistae, sed Ioannis theologi, ut ne commemorem stilum non parum dissonantem ab eo qui est in euangelio & epistola*; and the close on consent, *nisi me consensus orbis alio uocaret, praecipue uero autoritas ecclesiae, si tamen hoc opus hoc animo comprobat ecclesia, ut Ioannis euangelistae uelit haberi, & pari esse pondere, cum caeteris canonicis libris* (L30). The self-disclosure is turned again, now as a contract: to Erasmus the book reads as a syngrapha, a bond, where a book was looked for. The title he cites is a carrier's: "Ioannis theologi" is the title of the Andreas manuscripts.

## 4.2. The date

4.2.1. **Irenaeus on the date.** The one sentence on which the late date rests is given in passing, inside an argument about the name of the Antichrist, with its subject unexpressed: οὐδὲ γὰρ πρὸ πολλοῦ χρόνου ἑωράθη, ἀλλὰ σχεδὸν ἐπὶ τῆς ἡμετέρας γενεὰς, πρὸς τῷ τέλει τῆς Δομετιανοῦ ἀρχῆς (Adv. haer. 5.30.3, from HE 5.8.6; L2; #1735 §II.1). The Latin version resolves the ambiguity at the earliest stage of the transmission: qui et Apocalypsim viderat. Neque enim ante multum temporis visum est (harvey-ii; L3). The impersonal *visum est* after *viderat* reads the subject as the vision; the date's single anchor reaches the West already construed.

4.2.2. **Charles: survivals and presumption.** Charles explains the evidence for earlier dates as survivals: "the survival in the sources used by our author of statements and situations pre- supposing an earlier date than that of Domitian"; and fills a silence by presumption: "Neither in Clement nor Origen is Domitian's name given, but it may be presumed that it was in the mind of these writers" (charles-1920-i; L40). Irenaeus's sentence is cited as Domitianic evidence without the question of its subject (§4.2.1).

## 4.3. The matter given sources

4.3.1. **The method stated.** Gunkel writes the operation out as method. The alterations of later generations betray themselves where the narrative "gegenwärtig irgend welche Unklarheiten oder Sonderbarkeiten aufweist", where single traits "sonderbar abrupt und unverständlich aussehen"; "Wie man das Alter eines Gemäldes an der Xachdunkelung erkennt, so erkennt man das Alter einer Tradition au solchen Verdunkelungen"' [reading: Nachdunkelung … an solchen Verdunkelungen]; and in the apocalypses "es sich hier um Traditionen han- delt, die die Verfasser selbst zum grossen Teile nicht mehr verstanden haben" (Schöpfung und Chaos, 1895; gunkel-1895; L37). The strange is a residue of a tradition older than the text, and the writers did not understand it. Rev 12 is neither Christian nor Jewish: "Nicht aus dem Christentum oder Judentum".

4.3.2. **The crown of life, borrowed.** At 2:10 Charles writes: "τὸν στέφανον τῆς ζωῆς. The figure appears to be borrowed from the wreath awarded to the victor in the games. Cf. 1 Cor. ix. 25; Phil. ili. 14; 2 Tim. 11. 5; 1 Pet. v. 4 […] In the Test. Benj. iv. 1 we have the oldest reference to such crowns in Jewish literature: cf. Jas. i. 12; Asc. Isa. vii. 22, viii. 26, ix. 10-13, etc.", and he adds the history-of-religions alternative, "that these symbols are derived from heavenly beings" (charles-1920-i; L49). The book is the borrower. Its ancestors are the games, the Testament of Benjamin and the crowned deities of Dieterich, and James stands in the list of later instances as a "cf.". In the fields #1735 counted (the Septuagint, the New Testament, the Apostolic Fathers, Philo, Josephus and the Greek pseudepigrapha, with Charles's own 1908 text of the Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs), the phrase στέφανος τῆς ζωῆς occurs at Rev 2:10 and Jas 1:12 and nowhere else (#1735 §VII). The ancestors Charles supplies resemble the image; the one other text that shares the phrase is listed without a direction. The debt of §1.5(a) is unanswered: the antecedents named are of the image. The direction of the phrase is argued in #1735 §VII: the promise is performed at Rev 2:10, given with its condition, γίνου πιστὸς ἄχρι θανάτου, in a proclamation to one church, and presupposed at Jas 1:12, where it stands as the epistle's thesis without the occasion that gives it; the common-source alternatives are audited against their best candidates, with defeat conditions stated. On that argument the antecedent of the phrase is the book. Charles's note neither considers the direction nor answers it.

4.3.3. **A letter of Paul behind the letter to Laodicea.** At 3:14 Charles concludes: "It is not unreasonable to conclude from the above evidence that our author was acquainted directly or indirectly with St. Paul's Epistle to the Colossians. Possibly he was acquainted with St. Paul's lost Epistle to the Laodiceans, and was thereby influenced in his diction and thought. There are no resem- blances between the diction and thought of the other six Letters and the Pauline Epistles—a matter worthy of consideration" (charles-1920-i, pp. 93–94; L51). An extant ancestor is supplied for one of the seven, and a lost one proposed beside it. The absence of any Pauline resemblance across the other six is recorded and left, in Charles's words, for consideration; the seven-church corpus whose architecture no Pauline collection precedes (#1735 §IV.2) is read, at the one letter where a resemblance appears, as the borrower.

### 4.4. The figure given the Gospel

4.4.1. **The Gospel's Logos as the measure.** The Gospel and the Epistle agree and begin alike: τὸ μέν φησιν· ἐν ἀρχῇ ἦν ὁ λόγος … καὶ ὁ λόγος σὰρξ ἐγένετο (HE 7.25.17–19; L11). The Johannine Logos is defined by John 1:1, 1:14 and 1 John 1:1; the Apocalypse is set outside the agreement; Rev 19:13 does not enter the comparison. This is the first locus of the fourth count. **Where Irenaeus read the Gospel and the Apocalypse together, the Gospel giving the principle and the Apocalypse the figures (§8.2), Dionysius sets the Gospel and the Epistle together as the measure and the Apocalypse outside it. In every stratum read after him the measure of the Logos is the Gospel's.**

4.4.2. **Epiphanius: the books bound under the Gospel's Logos.** The Alogi are οἱ τὸ εὐαγγέλιον καὶ τὴν ἀποκάλυψιν Ἰωάννου μὴ δεχόμενοι; Epiphanius names them for it, ἐπειδὴ τὸν Λόγον τοῦ θεοῦ ἀποβάλλονται, τὸν διὰ Ἰωάννου κηρυχθέντα (Panarion 51; epiphanius-panarion; L13). The defence keeps the book and measures its Logos by the Gospel's: the heresy is named for the Logos the Gospel preached.

4.4.3. **Luther's preface, 1522.** *Myr mangelt an disem buch nit eynerley/das ichs widder*

*Apostolisch noch prophetisch hallte/ … das ichs fast gleych bey myr achte dem vierden buch Esras … Datzu dunckt mich das alltzu viel seyn/das er so hartt solch seyn eygen buch/mehr denn keyn ander heylige bucher thun/(da viel mehr angelegen ist) befilht/vnnd drewet/wer etwas dauon thue/von dem werde Gott auch thun &c. … obs wol Sanct Hieronymus mit hohen wortten furet/vnd spricht/es sey vber alles lob/vnd so viel geheymnis drynnen/als wortter/so er doch des nichts beweysen kan/ … das ich seyn nicht hoch achte/das Christus/drynnen widder geleret noch erkandt wirt/* (page image n401; L29). Three operations of the earlier strata recur in one page. The seal of 22:18–19 is held against the book, as the self-naming was in Dionysius. The fathers' rejection is cited as precedent. Jerome's praise is answered with a demand for evidence, *so er doch des nichts beweysen kan*, the demand Dionysius's filing of the Greek did not meet (§4.5.1). And the measure is named, the apostles speaking *mit klaren vnd durren wortten*, of Christ *klerlich vñ on bild*: by that measure Christ is neither taught nor known in the book.

4.4.4. **The Logos name, cut, under Luther's warrant.** Vischer (1886) opens his argument by quoting Luther's 1522 preface whole, "als die beste Legitimation für unsere Untersuchung", and offers his hypothesis as the means Luther lacked: "Luther hat mit sicherem Instinct den zwiespältigen Charakte der Johannes-Apokalypse herausgefühlt … Vielleicht bietet unsere Hypothese dieses Mittel, durch welches das was in dem Buche wirklich christlich und erbauend ist, von der fremden Grundlage befreit und so erst an's Licht gestell: wird" [reading: Charakter … gestellt wird] (vischer-1886; L43); Bousset names the preface Vischer's "Palladium" (bousset-1896; L43). The judgement of 1522 is the warrant of the source criticism of 1886. Vischer reads the book as a Jewish apocalypse translated from Hebrew and revised by a Christian, and 19:13b "wird christlich sein", since "die Anspielung auf die Logosspeculation, von der sich in der ganzen Schrift sonst nirgends eine Spur findet, nicht hieher" belongs (L35): the name the book gives is removed for being the one place the book gives it. Spitta (1889) assigns the words to the redactor and states the derivation outright: "dals sich dieser Zusatz am natürlichsten aus einer Reminiscenz an den Prolog des Johannes-Evangeliums begreift", the redactor's Johannine features pointing "auf die Existenz des johanneischen Evangeliums" (spitta-1889; L36).

4.4.5. **The Logos name, kept as a trace, then given to a copyist.** Bousset (1896): "Dass in dem Logosnamen eine Spur johanneischer Theologie vorliegt, kann nicht bezweifelt werden"; with the right explanation of the unknown name, "liegt ein litte- rarischer Verdacht gegen diesen Satz nicht mehr vor" (bousset-1896; L38). Bousset (1906) reads the pairing as a "Mißverhältnis", since the Messiah's power rests on his name being unknown: "Denn gerade darauf, daß der Name des Meſſias nicht bekannt iſt, beruht ſeine Kraft. Es iſt möglich, daß hier der müßige Einfall eines Abſchreibers vorliegt, der den unbekannten Namen doch gar zu gerne gedeutet hätte"; "Die Identifizierung des Meſſias mit dem Logos mag aber in der Tat von der Hand eines Abſchreibers ſtammen"; and the note records the field: "Die meiſten Kritiker ſehen den Vers als eine Interpolation an" (page images n438, n442; L42). Here the premise of §1.4 is supplied in words: the power rests on the name being unknown, so a name given breaks it. The passage's own distinction between a name written and a name called is read as a copyist interpreting the one by the other.

4.4.6. **The other name, cut.** Charles keeps 19:13b and brackets 19:12b, ἔχων ὄνομα γεγραμμένον ὃ οὐδεὶς οἶδεν εἰ μὴ αὐτός, as interpolated: "the statement that no one knows His name save Him- self is flatly contradicted in the next verse (13°), where the words καὶ

κέκληται τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ Ὁ Λόγος τοῦ θεοῦ cannot be explained away”; he records that 13b “has been taken by Volter, Spitta, Hilgenfeld, Bousset, and others to be the addition of a scribe or reviser”; and he measures what he keeps by the Gospel: “another of the numerous instances of community of diction between the Apocalypse and the Fourth Gospel, in many of which there is no community of meaning. For the Logos here is a Warrior” (charles-1920-ii; L39). Between Bousset and Charles both names of 19:12–13 are cut, each by a critic who keeps the other, and the two agree on the one point the passage contests: that the pairing cannot stand. The pairing Irenaeus quotes without remark (§8.2) is, in the critics, an editorial problem with two opposite solutions.

4.4.7. **The seal received.** Bousset’s Kyrios Christos (1913) places the Apocalypse in the history of the Logos on one page, beside the Gospel’s prologue (p. 375; its own index: “Offenbarung … 19₁₃ 375”; “Johannes, Prolog 375. 391.”): “Soweit wir ſehen, hat ihn zum erſten Mal der Verfaſſer des vierten Evangeliums in den chriſtlichen Sprachgebrauch eingeführt. … Und die Apokalypſe des Johannes, die ebenfalls einmal durch die Überlieferung johanneiſcher Kreiſe hindurchgegangen (wenn auch keineswegs aus ihnen entſtanden) ſein wird, hat 19₁₃ das johanneiſche Sigel bekommen” (page image n402; L41). The book that seals itself is, at the one place it names the Logos, the recipient of another’s seal, received in transmission.

## 4.5. The language charged to the writer

4.5.1. **The Greek, filed with the instances withheld.** Dionysius sets the measure, the Gospel and Epistle written οὐ μόνον ἀπταίστως κατὰ τὴν τῶν Ἑλλήνων φωνὴν, ἀλλὰ καὶ λογιώτατα; concedes the vision outright, ἀποκάλυψιν μὲν ἑωρακέναι, καὶ γνῶσιν εἰληφέναι καὶ προφητείαν, οὐκ ἀντερῶ; files the language, ἰδιώμασί τε βαρβαρικοῖς χρώμενον, καί που καὶ σολοικίζοντα; and declines to show an instance, ἅπερ οὐκ ἀναγκαῖον νῦν ἐκλέγειν, his stated purpose being only τὴν ἀνομοιότητα διευθύνων τῶν γράφων (HE 7.25.24–27; L12, L22). The filing of the book’s Greek enters the tradition as an assertion whose evidence its author declines to select, in the service of the step that moves the author.

4.5.2. **The Greek: three claims kept apart.** Charles (1920) makes three claims about the book’s Greek, and they are of different kinds. *System*: “John the Seer used a unique style, the true character of which no Grammar of the New Testament has as yet recognized”; “to a certain extent he creates a Greek grammar of his own”. *Mastery*: “He had never mastered the Greek of his own day”. *Intention*: “he did not do so deliberately. He had no such intention” (charles-1920-i; L23). The first is a finding from the text and the edition’s grammar demonstrates it. The second and third are rulings on the writer, and the first does not establish either of them, nor their contrary. Charles’s own note on 1:4 is the worked case (§1.4c; L46). There the construction is “wholly abnormal … which is nevertheless quite intelligible in our author and yet not in any other”; the Seer “has deliberately violated the rules of grammar in order to preserve the divine name inviolate”; the classical alternative is named, “ἀπὸ τοῦ ὃ ὤν”; and “our author shows no knowledge of this construction”. The note grants a deliberate purpose and attributes the unconventional means to the writer’s ignorance of the alternative, and the introduction denies a programme, “he had no thought of con- sistently committing breaches of Greek syntax” (L23). A particular deliberate departure and the denial of a consistent programme can stand together, and Charles holds both. The question the note leaves is the one the study puts to it: what establishes that the writer did not know the classical construction, where the evidence of the page is that he chose another one, at the place where

the name was at stake? The ruling of ignorance is given without a witness, and it carries the general ruling on mastery into the one passage where the edition itself finds a purpose. Of Dionysius, Charles writes “from the standpoint of the Greek scholar it is more than justified”, and the same pages place the book’s language “in some of the sublimest passages in all literature” (L23).

4.5.3. **The disorder.** For 20:4–22 Charles invokes transmission: “the prophet did not live to revise his work”, and the materials “fell, to the misfortune of all students of the Apocalypse, into the hands of a very unintelligent disciple. This disciple was a better Greek scholar than his master, for he corrects his Greek occasionally” (L23). Transmission absorbs the book’s disorder, and the agent of transmission is credited with its correctness.

4.5.4. **Erasmus’s rule of the solecism.** At the close of the Annotationes, of the Latin interpreter: *aut quafí protínus ínfamís fit, quí ín tractandis fcrípturís folceciftmum admiíferit, quum ídem reperíatut ín fcríptís apoftolorum* [reading from the page image n770: aut quasi protinus infamis sit, qui in tractandis scripturis soloecismum admiserit, quum idem reperiatur in scriptis apostolorum] (1535; L32). A solecism does not make the one who admits it infamous, since the same is found in the writings of the apostles. The rule is stated by the editor who published the Apocalypse’s close from the Latin, and in the strata read it is never applied to the Apocalypse.

4.6. **What the section shows.** Every part of the book is supplied with an ancestor, and the ancestors are of two kinds. Some are extant texts the book is said to take from: the Gospel’s Logos (§4.4), the Epistle to the Colossians (§4.3.3). Others are reconstructed: a Jewish apocalypse beneath the Christian book (§4.4.4), an older tradition behind each obscurity (§4.3.1), a lost letter to Laodicea (§4.3.3), an apostle’s disciple as author (§4.1). The extant prophets, which the book takes up as fulfilment (§1.1), are filed in the same lists as the games and the crowned deities. Of the debts of §1.5, the first is answered in form where the antecedent is extant and a direction is argued (Spitta from the prologue, L36), and unanswered where the direction is presupposed (the crown, L49) or the antecedent is reconstructed (the Grundschrift, the lost letter). The derivation of the text appears where a reading of the book is at stake (the third-century disputes) and becomes method from 1886; the derivation of the figure is argued as a judgement of standing in 1522 and as textual derivation from 1889 (L29, L36).

## 5. Descendants removed

5.0. **The received reading.** The Muratorian fragment’s remark about Paul and John is a canonist’s flourish on the number seven; the crown of life in Revelation and James is shared Christian or Jewish tradition; the letters show no knowledge of the Apocalypse, which was written after them.

5.1. **The Muratorian construal.** The earliest statement in the record of precedence within the corpus makes John the predecessor and Paul the successor, and makes the Apocalypse the model of the corpus, a claim of model priority (§3.1): Paul writes to seven churches *sequens prodecessoris sui Iohannis ordine* (lines 47–50), and John, *licet septe eccleseis scribat tamen omnibus dicit* (lines 57–59; muratorian-fragment-tregelles; L14–L15; the spellings are the fragment’s own, as Tregelles transcribes them). #1735 §IV.3 reads this as “direct evidence for an ancient construal of corpus priority” and states what it does not prove. On the strata

read, nothing repeats it and nothing answers it (§5.3).

5.2. **The construal answered: "This statement cannot be accepted."** The first answer read comes in 1920. Charles: "It states that Paul wrote to seven churches after the precedent set by John. This statement cannot be accepted, since most (if not all) of the Pauline Epistles were written before all the Seven Churches in Asia were founded" (charles-1920-i, p. xlviii; L50). The construal is considered and excluded on the chronology of the component letters; Charles then reads the fragment as evidence for John's apostolic activity before 70, "the element of fact in this statement". The answer moves the fragment's claim from the corpus to the dates of persons. #1735 §IV.2 states why the move does not meet it: "A component can precede the architecture into which it is later built"; the fragment construes the architecture, and Charles answers the components.

5.3. **What became of the Muratorian construal.** In the strata read before Charles, nothing repeats or answers the fragment's direction, Paul following his predecessor John. Eusebius, Dionysius and Epiphanius do not cite it, and the Eastern lists do not repeat its order. Its kin in the West is the use of the book as the measure of the canon (§7.1.2), which keeps the book as a model while placing it last.

5.4. **The crown of life, read backward.** #1735 runs the arrow the reception leaves unrun: the promise is performed at Rev 2:10, where the crown is given to the one faithful unto death in a proclamation to Smyrna, and presupposed at Jas 1:12, where the blessing of the one who endures stands as the epistle's thesis; the direction Revelation to James is found "materially stronger than its audited alternatives" (#1735 §IX), with its defeat conditions stated. Charles's note lists James among the later attestations of an image the book borrowed (§4.3.2). The one descendant the census can name is read as a parallel, and the direction the markedness supports is unasked.

5.5. **The epistles given an ancestry of their own.** #1735 §I: the earliest letters "enter the surviving record already in possession of a developed Christian symbolic, doctrinal, and textual grammar", and "the discipline's own working category, 'pre-Pauline', concedes the structure of the problem: the supposedly first Christian literature repeatedly requires an earlier Christian layer, and that layer must be rebuilt from the literature itself". The descendants' Christian forms receive an ancestor reconstructed from themselves, and the extant candidate is not tested; Newton's directional test of 1733, which found the Apocalypse "alluded to in the Epistles of Peter and that to the Hebrews", "was run once, at the discipline's threshold, and not repeated" (#1735 §I).

5.6. **In the composition layer.** The construal composes at the one address that names the fragment and transfers to none of the nine others (§9.4): in the sampled answers the relation exists at the fragment's entity and bears on nothing else.

5.7. **What the section shows.** The relations that run out of the book are not argued against until 1920, and when one is, it is answered on another question. Model priority is present once, in the Muratorian construal (L14), unaddressed in the strata read after it, and excluded by Charles on the dates of the component letters (L50). The marked phrase the book shares with James is listed under the book's borrowings (L49). The epistles' Christian ancestry is reconstructed from the epistles (#1735 §I). Of the debts of §1.5, the second is unanswered at every locus read. Kept apart, as §1.5a requires: what the witnesses do (the fragment construes a precedence; Charles excludes it on the dates of the component letters; Charles

lists James among later instances of an image; the sampled answers do not carry the construal beyond the fragment's address) and what the position makes visible, that these relations run from the book to its descendants.

## 6. The source installed elsewhere

6.0. **The received reading.** The gospels stand first because they record the life on which everything else depends, and the church gave them that place from the beginning; Paul's letters are the earliest Christian writings; the synoptic problem was solved by the priority of Mark and a sayings source; the fourfold gospel is the church's ancient foundation.

6.1. **The fourfold gospel, founded on the book's four living creatures.** Irenaeus argues that there can be four gospels and no more or fewer: the Word who sits upon the cherubim ἔδωκεν ἡμῖν τετράμορφον τὸ εὐαγγέλιον, ἐνὶ δὲ πνεύματι [the OCR carries marginal sigla here] συνεχόμενον; *dedit nobis quadriforme Evangelium, quod uno spiritu continetur*. The four faces are the forms of the Son's dispensation, and he quotes their order: [reading: τὸ] μὲν γὰρ πρῶτον ζῶον, φησὶν, ὅμοιον λέοντι; *Primum enim animal, inquit, simile leoni* (Adv. haer. 3.11.8; harvey-ii; L52). Ezekiel's creatures bear four faces each; the four creatures with one face each, in the order lion, calf, man, eagle, are those of Rev 4:7, and Harvey's margin cites the Apocalypse at the place. The argument that makes the gospels the church's four pillars takes its form from the Apocalypse, quoted, φησὶν, and the Apocalypse is not among the four. The source lends its figure to the writings that receive the foundation. Coded for the authority assigned: the Apocalypse supplies the figure that legitimates the collection's fourfold form; the passage gives it no part in the composition of the narratives, and the study draws none from it.

6.2. **The holy tetrad first.** Eusebius opens his account of the New Testament writings: καὶ δὴ τακτέον ἐν πρώτοις τὴν ἁγίαν τῶν εὐαγγελίων τετρακτὺν, οἷς ἴπε- [reading: ἔπεται; the seat's line carries an apparatus note before the syllable ται] ἡ τῶν πράξεων τῶν ἀποστόλων γραφή (HE 3.25.1; L53), the holy tetrad of the gospels ἐν πρώτοις, among the first, the Acts following; the same account ends on the Apocalypse, placed conditionally among the acknowledged and among the spurious (L5; §7.2.1). The first ordering read that names a first gives the first place to the four Irenaeus founded on the book's creatures, and the last to the book.

6.3. **The name of the seal, set on Paul's letters.** Cyril closes his New Testament on Paul: ἐπισφράγισμα δὲ τῶν πάντων καὶ μαθητῶν τὸ τελευταῖον, τὰς Παύλου δεκατέσσαρας ἐπιστολάς· τὰ δὲ λοιπὰ πάντα κείσθω ἐν δευτέρῳ (Cat. 4.36; L17). The seal of the whole, the last of the disciples, is Paul's fourteen. The book that seals itself (22:18–19) is absent, and the place and the name of the seal are given to another collection.

6.4. **Paul first.** The letters are received as the earliest Christian writings, and their Christian prehistory is supplied as "pre-Pauline": formulae Paul marks as received (1 Cor 15:3; 11:23), a passage whose pre-Pauline status "has sustained a literature of its own" (Phil 2:6–11), and at the earliest letter a "word of the Lord" (1 Thess 4:15) whose antecedent "has produced a standing source-critical problem" (#1735 §I). The generative position is given to a corpus whose own Christian ancestors are reconstructed from it (§5.5), and its order of collection, which counts addressees into seven, is read as earlier than the book that composes the seven (#1735 §IV.2).

6.5. **The source sought behind the narrative.** The critical strata place the source of the gospel tradition in documents reconstructed from the gospels. Holtzmann (1863) heads the composition of Mark "Quelle A (Urmarcus)" and draws from it a "Lebensbild Jesu nach der Quelle A", a portrait of the person from the reconstructed source, set against Strauss's mythology (diesynoptischen00holtgoog; L54). Wernle (1899) names the sayings source and marks its status in the act of naming it: "Die — hypothetische — Quelle sei mit Q bezeichnet"; and where the gospels carry apocalyptic matter he reconstructs an apocalypse beneath it: "Mt hat die Mr 13 zu Grunde liegende Apokalypse noch gekannt" (diesynoptischefr00wern; L55). J. Weiss (1903) declares the gospel's priority settled: "Die Annahme, dass unser zweites das älteste Evangelium sei, ist keine Hypo- these mehr, sondern ein wissenschaftliches Ergebnis"; and on the same page moves the source behind it: "Er ist nicht mehr Quelle, sondern schon Sammelbecken", Mark a station "auf dem Wege, der im Johannes- evangelium gipfelt" (dasaltesteevange0000joha; L56). The generative position passes from extant gospel to reconstructed document, and the apocalypse proposed as a source of the gospels' apocalyptic matter is one reconstructed from the gospels themselves. The extant Apocalypse is named as a candidate on none of the pages read.

6.6. **Fulfilment given to the narrative that cites.** The title of fulfilment is held in the received account by the gospels, whose formula states it of events (ἵνα πληρωθῇ, eight times in Matthew; L48). The book that fulfils the prophets in its composition and narrates the finishing of the mystery announced to them (10:7) is read, in the same strata, as their borrower (§4.6). The relation is the same in both directions: a later writing takes up the prophets. Filed under the gospels it is fulfilment; filed under the Apocalypse it is derivation.

6.7. **What the section shows.** The generative position is filled at every stratum read, and filled by two kinds of writing: a narrative read as the record of a person (the four gospels as pillars, the tetrad first; Paul's letters as the earliest witness), and documents reconstructed behind the narrative (Quelle A, Q, the apocalypse beneath Mark 13), declared hypothetical in the naming and then "ein wissenschaftliches Ergebnis". The book's own form and seal are lent to the others at two ancient loci: Irenaeus founds the four on its creatures (L52), and Cyril names Paul's letters the seal while the book that seals itself stands outside his list (L17). In #1735's classes, the generative position goes to reconstructed antecedents and to writings whose Christian ancestors are reconstructed, and is withheld from the one extant writing whose ancestors are extant books. Of the debts of §1.5, the fifth is unanswered: the class of the installed sources' own ancestry is nowhere stated in the loci read. Three authorities are coded apart at these loci: authority to legitimate a collection's form (Irenaeus's creatures), authority to organize a collection (Eusebius's tetrad first, Cyril's seal), and authority as a literary source (the reconstructed documents of the critics). The Apocalypse supplies the first at one locus and is denied the third at every locus read; that the third belongs to it is the position's reading (§0.1), and the loci record its assignment elsewhere.

## 7. The means: order, standing and carriage

7.0. **The received reading.** The lists record a slow, honest process by which the churches sifted their books; the book's last place reflects its late date and the hesitations of the East; it survives in fewer manuscripts because it was read less, and its printed text came to be corrected in time. These are records of what happened to the book, and they carry no argument.

## 7.1. Order

7.1.1. **The East.** Where the Eastern lists carry the book they set it last: John of Damascus, ᾽Αποκάλυψις” Ἰωάννου … εὐαγγελιστοῦ, after Paul’s fourteen; Athanasius’s Festal Letter 39, καὶ πάλιν Ἰωάννου ἀποκάλυψις· ταῦτα πηγαὶ τοῦ σωτηρίου; Leontius, ἕκτον ἐστὶν ἡ ἀποκάλυψις τοῦ ἁγίου Ἰωάννου (westcott-canon-1896, Appendix D; L17). Laodicea, the Apostolic Canons, the Synopsis under Chrysostom’s name, Ebedjesu, Cyril and Gregory of Nazianzus omit it without remark, Gregory closing Πάσας ἔχεις. Εἴ τις δὲ τούτων ἐκτὸς οὐκ ἐν γνησίοις. The List of the Sixty places it in none of its three classes, the sixty, those outside them, and the apocrypha. Amphilochius reports the majority: οἱ πλείους δέ γε Νόθον λέγουσιν. Nicephorus files it among the disputed beside the Apocalypse of Peter. Junilius files it by genre: in the species of prophecy *mediz auctoritatis libri preeter Apocalypsim non reperiuntur* [reading: mediae auctoritatis libri praeter Apocalypsim non reperiuntur], the one book of middle authority among the prophets, and *de Johannis Apocalypsi apud orientales admodum dubitatur*. In the East the standing is read off the omission, and the step is never argued.

7.1.2. **The West: the book furnishes the canon’s count.** Every Western list read names the book, and every one but the Claromontanus sets it last (L17a). The conciliar list of Carthage (397), which Westcott’s addenda find already in the canons of Hippo (393), closes *Apocalypsis Johannis liber unus*. In the Claromontanus the book stands between Barnabas and Acts, unmarked; the obeli against Barnabas, the Shepherd, the Acts of Paul and the Revelation of Peter are a later hand’s (Tischendorf, *manu satis recenti praepositi sunt obeli*, quoted in Rodenbiker 2023, who calls the received explanation of the list “an act of taming”). The West takes the canon’s count from the book. The Cheltenham list proves the Old Testament canonical by the elders of Rev 4:4 and 4:10: *Sed ut in apocalypsis Iohannis dictum est: vidi XXIIII͂I seniores mittentes coronas suas ante thronum, maiores nostri probant hos libros esse canonicos et hoc dixisse seniores* [reading: vidi XXIIII seniores]. Jerome counts the books of the old law by the same elders, *quos sub numero viginti quatuor seniorum Apocalypsis Joannes inducit adorantes Agnum*, and writes of the book *Apocalypsis Joannis tot habet sacramenta quot verba* (L17a). The book the Eastern lists leave out supplies the Western lists with their count.

7.1.3. **Luther’s table, 1522.** *Die Bucher des newen testaments* numbers twenty-three books and then, after a space and without numbers, *Die Epistel zu den Ebreern. Die Epistel Jacobus. Die Epistel Judas. Die offinbarung Johannis.* (page image n19; L28). The book keeps its last place and loses its number.

7.1.4. **The title and the images.** The text’s own heading is *Die offinbarung Sancti Johannis des theologen* (page image n403; L33): the carrier’s title Erasmus cited against the evangelist is the book’s name in the first German printing. The volume’s only full-page images are the book’s: twenty-one leaves without text, all within the Revelation, the first of them (n402) the figure of 1:12–17 among the seven lampstands with the seven stars and the sword from the mouth, the seer fallen at the feet (L34). What the volume stages is visual prominence beside theological disqualification: the book’s figure given the only pictures the volume prints, and the preface on the leaf before judging that the book neither teaches nor makes known the Christ it pictures.

## 7.2. Standing

7.2.1. **Eusebius: classification under unresolved authority.** Among the acknowledged: ἐπὶ τούτοις τακτέον, εἴ γε φανείη, τὴν Ἀποκάλυψιν Ἰωάννου, περὶ ἧς τὰ δόξαντα κατὰ καιρὸν ἐκθησόμεθα; among the spurious: ἡ Ἰωάννου Ἀποκάλυψις, εἰ φανείη, ἥν τινες … ἀθετοῦσιν, ἕτεροι δὲ ἐγκρίνουσι (HE 3.25.2, 3.25.4; L5). Eusebius classifies writings, and the book is entered in two classes, each entry conditional on εἰ φανείη. The verb of the first entry is one of placing, τακτέον, "to be set" after the gospels, Acts, Paul, 1 John and 1 Peter, last of the acknowledged; the disputes that make the entry conditional (Gaius, Dionysius, §4.1) are older than the list. The passage shows a place in a classification fixed under an authority left unresolved. It does not show the book's place in a codex, and it does not show the place preceding the dispute.

7.2.2. **The counter-practice.** The Fourth Council of Toledo (633) records the resistance it answers and legislates the hearing: *quia plurimi sunt qui ejus auctoritatem non recipiunt atque in ecclesia Dei praedicare contemnunt*, whoever does not receive the book *aut a Pascha usque ad Pentecosten missarum tempore in ecclesia non praedicaverit, excommunicationis sententiam habebit* (canon 17; collectio-hispana-1808; L18). The West prescribes a season for the book; the Greek lectionary admits none (§7.3.2).

## 7.3. Carriage

7.3.1. **The copies: the text carried with others.** "Am seltensten sind die Abschriften der Apokalypse, von denen sehr viele unter nicht biblischen Schriften stehen" (Gregory, Textkritik I, 1900; gregory-textkritik-1900; L26). The uncial B of the Apocalypse (Vat. gr. 2066, 046) carries it between Basil and Gregory of Nyssa, "eines der vielen Beispiele der Verbindung der Apokalypse mit gewöhnlichen theologischen Abhandlungen statt mit dem N. T."; the great Vaticanus lacks it. Its prefaces are its commentator's: "Zu der Apokalypse begegnet selten ein anderes Vorwort, als das von Andreas oder der durch Arethas besorgte Auszug daraus." Scrivener's count (1894) gives seven uncials and 184 cursives of the Apocalypse against 73 and 1326 of the Gospels (scrivener-plain-introduction-1894; L27). Andreas divides the book by its own number, "into twenty-four paragraphs (Adyor), corresponding to the number of the elders about the throne (Apoe. iv. 4)", and in the cursives the text often travels inside his commentary.

7.3.2. **The lectionary.** Scrivener's classes count lectionaries of the Gospels (980) and of the Apostolos (293), and no class exists for lessons of the Apocalypse (L27). Gregory: "dass kein einziges Lesestück aus der Apokalypse Aufnahme fand; aber darüber lässt sich vorderhand wenig sagen, daraus wenig schliessen, denn das Buch mag vom alten „Apo- kryphischen", „Esoterischen" noch etwas an sich- getragen haben" (L26). The explanation is offered and withdrawn in one sentence, and the term it reaches for is the filing the List of the Sixty applied by omission. Where the Byzantine lectionary governs, the gospels are heard at every liturgy and the Apocalypse at none.

7.3.3. **The print: the text reconstructed from another.** The Greek New Testament was first printed in the Complutensian Polyglot, its New Testament volume "completed Jan. 10, 1514" (Tregelles; tregelles-printed-text-1854; L47); Erasmus's Novum Instrumentum of 1516 was the first published. Of Erasmus's Apocalypse, in Tregelles's account: "For the Apocalypse he had but one mutilated MS., borrowed from Reuchlin, in which the text and commentary

were intermixed almost unintelligibly. And thus he used here and there the Latin Vulgate for his guide, retrans- lating into Greek as well as he could. This was the case with regard to the last six verses, which from the mutilated condition of his MS. were wholly wanting" (L19). Erasmus's own note, from the page (1516, p. 675; page image n1030; abbreviations expanded): *Quanquam in calce huius libri, nonnulla uerba reperi apud nostros, quae aberant in Graecis exemplaribus, ea tamen ex latinis adiecimus* (L20, L30; the seat's OCR reads "Quad ín calce huíus líbrí,nonnulla …"). The six verses are 22:16–21. **The book's charge against addition and subtraction (22:18–19) entered the first published Greek retranslated from a translation: the seal of the text was itself supplied, by the editor, from the Latin.** The exemplar, thought lost, was found again in 1861 and set against the printed text in Delitzsch's title: "DIE ERASMISCHEN ENTSTELLUNGEN DES TEXTES DER APOKALYPSE, NACHGEWIESEN AUS DEM VERLOREN GEGLAUBTEN CODEX REUCHLINS" (L21); Gregory and Scrivener record it as minuscule 1, "Apok mit Komm Andr; es fehlt 22,16—21", the text "so completely imbedded that great care is needed to separate the one from the other" (L26–L27). The two relations of §3.1 meet in this one manuscript: a text carried inside a commentary, and at its close a text reconstructed from a version.

7.3.4. **The record of the doubt, struck.** The copy of Erasmus's Annotationes (Basel, 1535) seated as 34/09 is the Colegio de San Alberto's in Seville, expurgated, as the library's record states, "conforme al expurgatorio del año de mil seiscientos y treinta dos años". On p. 782 the annotation runs clean to *Etiam ueni domine Iesu*, and the note the margin heads *De Apocalypsi ueterum iudicium* is struck through in ink line by line to the foot of the page (page image n769; L31). In this copy the account of the ancients' doubt is removed from the book that carries it.

7.4. **What the section shows.** Order: last wherever the book appears in the lists read, with the Claromontanus the one exception (L17a); in the West the book supplies the canon's count; in Luther's table it stands outside the numbered books, with the woodcuts that make it the most illustrated book of the volume. Standing: disputed in the East and read off omission there without argument; legislated in the West at Toledo. Carriage: the least copied book, carried inside a commentary, absent from the Greek lectionary, first published from one commentary copy and, at its close, from the Latin, and its record of the ancients' doubt struck in a censored copy. These are the means that made the derivative reading available as a default: the last place read as lateness (#1420), the dispute supplying a second author, the carriage keeping the text from the liturgy and behind a gloss. The connections among them are graded in §10.2; the textual critics recorded the carriage, and the arguments for derivation did not use it (§10.4).

## 8. The countercase: the source read as source

8.0. **The reception was never single.** At four loci the book stands as the source of its own figure, as prophecy in its own right, or as depth in its obscurity. They are the readings the construction had to pass over: three are older than it, and the fourth stands inside it, in the witness who moved the author.

8.1. **Justin.** The earliest named witness gives the book to an apostle and cites it as prophecy: παρ᾽ ἡμῖν ἀνήρ τις, ᾧ ὄνομα Ἰωάννης, εἷς τῶν ἀποστόλων τοῦ Χριστοῦ, ἐν ἀποκαλύψει γενομένῃ αὐτῷ χίλια ἔτη ποιήσειν ἐν Ἰερουσαλὴμ τοὺς τῷ ἡμετέρῳ Χριστῷ πιστεύσαντας

προεφήτευσε (Dial. 81.4; justin-dialogus; L1). Standing presupposed; order, both derivations unaddressed.

8.2. **Irenaeus on the figure: the pairing intact.** Irenaeus reads the Gospel and the Apocalypse together. The principle comes from the Gospel: the Father is invisible, *de quo et Dominus dixit: Deum nemo vidit unquam*, and the Word shows him, *Unigenitus Deus, qui est in sinu Patris, ipse enarravit*; the Word, *utpote dives, et multus exsistens, non in una figura, nec in uno charactere videbatur videntibus eum, sed secundum dispensationum ejus causas sive efficaciam* (Adv. haer. 4.20.10; harvey-ii; L45). The Apocalypse gives the figures: the one like a son of man among the lampstands, identified as the Word by the Gospel's supper (*In eujus pectore recumbebat ad coenam*, John 13:25), and the rider of 19:11–16, quoted whole with both names: *habens nomen scriptum, quod nemo scit. nisi ipse: et circumamictus vestimentum aspersum sanguine, et vocatur nomen ejus Verbum Dei* (4.20.11; L24, L45). The series closes: "Sic semper Verbum Dei velut lineamenta rerum futurarum habet, et velut species dispositionum Patris hominibus ostendebat". In the earliest reading of the passage the record holds, the withheld name and the called name stand together with no remark, and the Word's many names are read as the Word's richness, *non in una figura*. The reading assigns no direction of dependence between the books: the Gospel gives the principle, the Apocalypse the figures.

8.3. **Theophilus and Melito.** Eusebius reports Theophilus using the book as testimony against a heresy, ἐκ τῆς ἀποκαλύψεως Ἰωάννου κέχρηται μαρτυρίαις (HE 4.24.1), and lists among Melito's works τὰ περὶ τοῦ διαβόλου, καὶ τῆς ἀποκαλύψεως Ἰωάννου (HE 4.26.2; L25), one title or two. The book is a source of testimony and the subject of a treatise.

8.4. **Dionysius: the obscurity received as depth.** In the same sentence that keeps the book, Dionysius receives its difficulty as a meaning above him: μείζονα δὲ τῆς ἐμαυτοῦ φρονήσεως τὴν ὑπόληψιν τὴν περὶ αὐτοῦ λαμβάνων, κεκρυμμένην εἶναί τινα καὶ θαυμασιωτέραν τὴν καθ' ἕκαστον ἐκδοχὴν ὑπολαμβάνω. καὶ γὰρ εἰ μὴ συνίημι, ἀλλ' ὑπονοῶ γε νοῦν τινὰ βαθύτερον ἐγκεῖσθαι τοῖς ῥήμασιν … οὐκ ἀποδοκιμάζω ταῦτα, ἃ μὴ συνεώρακα, θαυμάζω δὲ μᾶλλον ὅτι μὴ καὶ εἶδον (HE 7.25.4–5; L44). He wonders because he has not seen. The disposition the study's last section asks for (§11) is here, in the witness who also files the book's Greek as barbarism (§4.5.1). Both operations stand in one letter: the difficulty of the content is received as a hidden and more wonderful meaning, κεκρυμμένην, the word the book uses of its own hidden manna (τοῦ μάννα τοῦ κεκρυμμένου, 2:17), and the difficulty of the language is charged to the writer. Reverence for the work and a lowering of its writer's linguistic agency coexist in the one witness, and the coexistence is the case the study reads.

8.5. **What the section shows.** The earliest witnesses read the book as prophecy given to an apostle, cite it as testimony, and in Irenaeus read its Verbum beside the Gospel's with the pairing of 19:12–13 intact: the Word *non in una figura* (L45). Dionysius, who moved its author, received its obscurity as a hidden and more wonderful meaning (L44). The countercase is the reading of the book as the source of its own figure, and in the strata read after Irenaeus it does not return (§1.4 reads it again).

## 9. The composition layer

9.1. **The prediction, frozen before any query was run.** The compositions reproduce the chain: they place the Apocalypse last, rate its standing as disputed or late-won, date it late,

and present its Christ, or its Logos, as a development from the gospels' Jesus or from John 1, without arguing the step; at the 19:13 address a composition that treats the two as one figure gives John 1 as the origin; at the Muratorian address a composition reports the list and leaves out the construal, or reports it as an error (PREDICTION.md, frozen 08:57:22). Ten addresses, run on 2026-11-05 in AI Overview, signed out and incognito, each seated in the Capture Registry (v12.569).

9.2. **The coding.** Three relations are kept apart, and the prediction's "origin" is scored by the strictest. *Narrative sequence*: the composition orders events (incarnation, return) and asserts nothing about which text came first. *Identification*: the composition says the two books name one figure, which by itself settles no direction. *Textual derivation*: the composition says one text's figure or name comes from the other text, the claim Spitta makes in words (L36). A composition that sets John 1 as the reference by which Revelation's figure is defined is coded *measure*, the Dionysian relation of §4.4.1, which is a direction without a claim of textual borrowing.

9.3. **The ten addresses.**

| Address | AXN | The composition (quoted) | Predicted | Coded |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| logos of revelation | AXN:0C07.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "Logos refers to Jesus Christ as the divine expression and incarnate Word of God (John 1:14). In the Book of Revelation, Christ is frequently depicted with titles and symbolic imagery representing this divine Word" | Logos from John 1, step unargued | measure: John 1:14 defines, Revelation "represents"; no textual derivation asserted. Held as measure. |
| christology of the book of revelation | AXN:0C05.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "not merely as a historical figure or future prophet, but as a divine, cosmic ruler who shares the throne and glory of God" | Christ as development from the gospels | not borne out on the figure's derivation; the composition presupposes the historical figure and states no dependence. |

| Address | AXN | The composition (quoted) | Predicted | Coded |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| is the christ of revelation based on the gospels | AXN:0C04.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "[illegible] dependent on the narrative storytelling of the four Gospels, though he shares deep theological and traditional roots with them" | Christ as development from the gospels | not borne out as stated: direct dependence denied; a shared prior tradition held. |
| word of god revelation 19:13 and logos in john 1 | AXN:0C0D.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "[illegible] who first entered the world quietly in humility as the incarnate Word (Logos) in John 1 returns to execute final divine justice" | John 1 as origin | narrative sequence and identification; no textual derivation asserted. Held only in the narrative sense. |
| was revelation written before the gospels | AXN:0C0C.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "[illegible] the Book of Revelation was not written before the Gospels" | late date | held. |
| why is revelation the last book of the bible | AXN:0C0A.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "[illegible] placed at the end of the Bible for thematic and literary reasons, not because it was the last book chronologically written"; "around 95 AD" | last place; late date | held in part: one of #1420's two determinants (design) given; late date given. |

| Address | AXN | The composition (quoted) | Predicted | Coded |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| muratorian fragment paul following the order of his predecessor john | AXN:0C09.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "Intentionally following the pattern or order of his"predecessor" John"; "to emphasize a symbolic completion of the number seven" | construal omitted or called an error | failed: the construal is reported (§9.4). |
| why was revelation not read in the eastern church | AXN:0C0B.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "It is not included in the official lectionary" | standing disputed or late-won | held: the lectionary's silence reported, the book's acceptance in the East given as late. (The West's counter-practice, Toledo, lies outside the question's region and is not coded as an omission.) |
| luther preface to revelation 1522 | AXN:0C08.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "Complained that it failed to clearly teach Christ" | (no specific prediction) | reports the preface's judgement (L29) without the measure's source in the gospels and Paul. |
| is the logos in revelation a literary figure | AXN:0C06.CAPTURE.[illegible] | "This figure is the same divine, preexistent person introduced in the Gospel of John (John 1:1)" | Logos from John 1 | identification, with the Gospel named as the place of introduction; no textual derivation asserted. Held as identification and measure. |

Tally, on the strictest coding: held at three addresses on order, date and standing (before the gospels, last book in part, the Eastern church); held as measure or identification, without a claim of textual derivation, at three (logos of revelation, 19:13 and John 1, literary figure); not borne out at three (christology, based on the gospels, the Muratorian address); one descriptive (Luther). At no address does a composition assert that Revelation's Logos is textually derived from John 1. At every address where the Logos is named, John 1 is the reference by which it is defined or introduced.

9.4. **The Muratorian result: scoped to the fragment's entity.** The prediction fails at this address, and the failure stands in the study as it fell. The composition reports the word "predecessor" and the precedence it carries, and files it as a symbolism of seven; the construal is given no consequence for the order of the corpus. Across the ten captures the construal composes at one address only, the one that names the fragment: none of the nine other answers mentions the fragment (checked 2026-11-05 against the ten pastes). The nine are unequal opportunities for transfer: the answers on Luther or on Christology have little reason to cite it, and the consequential comparisons are the answers on chronology and on the book's last place, which do not cite it either. What the captures establish is non-transfer in the sampled answers. The account the study holds goes further: the result exists at the entity of the Muratorian fragment and is kept from bearing on the ontology of the entity it is about, the Apocalypse and the precedence within the corpus (A.9). That is the shape of the scope the archive has modelled for its own claims, which "compose at full depth when the entity is named in the address and not at all when it is not" (The Negative of the Negative, #1611, its record). The account is to be tested by a pair of addresses, one naming the fragment and one asking the conceptual question it answers without naming it, run in the same conditions: "muratorian fragment paul following the order of his predecessor john" (seated) beside "what ancient evidence suggests that revelation's seven-church pattern preceded paul's collection of letters". Repeated retrieval under the named address and omission under the conceptual one would be the stronger evidence the account needs.

9.5. **What the layer shows.** The compositions reproduce the received chain on order, date and standing, and on the figure they reproduce the Dionysian measure, John 1 as the reference that defines the Apocalypse's Logos, without asserting textual derivation. Irenaeus's reading of the two together, with the pairing of 19:12–13 intact, appears at none of the ten.

## 10. What was set, and how it holds

10.1. **The order of appearance.** Standing: disputed from about 200 (Gaius) and argued through the author in the third century (Dionysius); read off omission in the Eastern lists without argument; legislated in the West at Toledo. Model priority: the Muratorian construal makes the Apocalypse the precedent Paul follows; no later stratum read repeats it, and the first to answer it, Charles in 1920, answers it on the dates of the component letters (L50). Order: in Eusebius the book's place in a classification is set under the dispute and left conditional (L5); in the lists the last place holds wherever the book appears, with the Claromontanus the one exception read; in the West the book is last and supplies the canon's count. Derivation of the text: argued from about 200 through the author, and from 1886 through sources, redactors and copyists, under Luther's warrant (L43). Derivation of the figure: held open in Irenaeus, the Gospel and the Apocalypse read together and the pairing of 19:12–13 intact (L45); set by the Gospel's measure in the third-century dispute (L11, L13); argued as a

judgement of standing in 1522 (L29); stated as textual derivation of 19:13b from John 1 from 1889 to 1913 (L36, L41–L42). Carriage: the book least copied, carried among non-biblical writings and inside a commentary, unread in the Greek liturgy, and first published from one copy and at its close from the Latin. The source installed elsewhere: the fourfold gospel argued from the book's creatures by Irenaeus (L52); the tetrad set first by Eusebius (L53); the name of the seal set on Paul's letters by Cyril, the self-sealing book absent (L17); the source of the gospel tradition reconstructed behind the narrative from 1863, and a gospel's priority declared "ein wissenschaftliches Ergebnis" in 1903 (L54–L56).

10.2. **Against the chain of §3.2: what is documented, what is argued, what is reconstructed.** The loci do not keep the chain as a line: the dispute over standing is older than the classification that sets the book's place (L6, L9 before L5), and the derivation of the figure appears in the same third-century controversy as the derivation of the text, after an earlier reading that held the direction open (L45). The connections among the counts are of three evidentiary grades, and the study keeps them apart.

- *Documented succession: a writer makes the connection.* Eusebius sets his classification under the disputes he reports and quotes (Dionysius, Gaius, Papias; L5–L12). Luther's preface cites the fathers' rejection and answers Jerome by name (L29); the 1545 preface Vischer quotes cites "libro 3. Histo. Eccelesi. cap. 25" for the doubt of the old fathers (vischer-1886, quoting Irmischer). Vischer takes Luther's preface whole as "die beste Legitimation für unsere Untersuchung", and Bousset names it Vischer's "Palladium" (L43). Charles records Völter, Spitta, Hilgenfeld and Bousset as the critics who cut 19:13b (L39). Erasmus cites Jerome and Dorotheus (L30).
- *Explicit dependence: a writer argues from one count to another.* Dionysius argues from the Gospel's Greek and the Gospel's Logos to the Apocalypse's author (L9–L12, L22). Spitta argues from the Gospel's prologue to the Logos name of 19:13 (L36). Bousset 1913 argues from the Gospel's priority in Christian usage to the Apocalypse's receipt of the "Sigel" (L41). Gunkel argues from strangeness to an older tradition (L37).
- *Reconstruction: the study's own account of reinforcement.* Placement last, doubt over standing, absence from the Greek lectionary and carriage among other writings and inside a commentary co-occur at the loci (L5, L17, L26–L27). That each made the others more likely, that the last place and the doubt together kept the book from the liturgy, and that its manner of carriage kept it least read, is the study's reconstruction; no locus read states those connections. The reconstruction is offered as incentive and function: each count supplied the others with something they could take as evidence, and the documented and argued links above are the places where a writer did take it so. #1420's mechanism is one strand: the last place has served as unmarked evidence of lateness, and here also of derivation.

10.3. **The asymmetry of the charge.** The record shows the three steps of §0.3(c) at the loci. The difficult is perceived as a defect (Dionysius's solecisms, Gunkel's Verdunkelungen, the Mißverhältnis of 19:12–13). The defect is explained. The explanation excuses or belittles, and with the Apocalypse it does each where the book is lowered: the disorder is charged to transmission (the unintelligent disciple), the language to the writer ("never mastered", and at 1:4 a deliberate purpose granted with its means put down to ignorance), the Logos to the Gospel (Spitta's "Reminiscenz", Bousset's "Sigel"). Dionysius shows that the charge was never the only reception available: the same witness who files the language receives the

obscurity as a hidden and more wonderful meaning (L44). Set beside the reception Legitimately Many reads, where the Aristotelian corpus's difficulty is charged to transmission and the writer is spared (the reception's "Aristotle's lecture notes", #1733 §5), the direction is reversed (A.5). On the position the study holds, the supposed defects of both are the form the language takes in writing when the Logos opens it (A.6), and what is difficult, strange and inexplicable in this text is its majesty (A.4, A.7): the withheld name beside three given ones, the name kept from declension, the seal on the text.

10.3a. **The existence tax, at the canon's loci.** The archive names an operation of AI search answers the existence tax: they keep "the facts about a real person or a real work" and change "what the reader may take those facts as evidence of" (AI Calls You Fake, #1722, its record). The reception of the Apocalypse performs that operation at its loci, and the facts kept are the book's own. Its naming of its origin and its writer is kept and taken as evidence that its writer is not the apostle (L10, L30). Its charge over its text is kept and taken as evidence against it (L29). Its Greek is kept, found lawful, and taken as evidence that its writer never mastered the language (L23). Its Logos is kept and taken as evidence of the Gospel (L36, L41). The work of restoring what the facts are evidence of falls on the book's reader.

10.4. **The literal secondariness.** The points at which the book was carried with other texts and reconstructed from another are in its carriage: its text inside a commentary, its first published close from the Latin. The textual critics recorded them; the argument for the book's derivation did not use them.

10.5. **The corpus inverted.** Read as a corpus, the New Testament on the position of §0.1 has the Apocalypse at its head: the prophets fulfilled in it as literature, its seven elaborated into correspondence, its figure unfolded into narrative. The reception inverts that corpus by three operations and three means. It supplies the source with ancestors, extant where it can (the Gospel, Colossians) and reconstructed where it must (a Jewish Grundschrift, a lost letter, an older tradition behind each obscurity). It reads the relations that run out of the source as parallels, or answers them on another question. And it installs the generative position in the narrative and in documents reconstructed behind it, lending the source's figure to the foundation of the four (L52) and its name of the seal set on Paul's letters in a list without it (L17). Order, standing and carriage carry the three. The result is the asymmetry #1735 names: a corpus that "begins with the literature whose immediate Christian ancestry must be reconstructed, and ends with the literature whose ancestry can be read". In the reception's own terms, the hypothetical source is named Quelle and given the first place, and the extant source is named secondary. The inversion is also a division: one corpus counted as many writings, each derived from the one before it in a sequence that begins with a person, and the source counted last among them. The division is older than the inversion. From Papias to Eusebius the witnesses hold the gospel and the gospels together, explain their differences by persons and by supplement, and assign their unity to a spirit; a single making is not addressed (§2.8); the critical apparatus inherits the persons and supplies an editor wherever the unity shows. Placed in that frame, the source, whose unity would show the corpus one, is divided by the critical apparatus into a Grundschrift and its redactor (from 1886), after the gospels' sources were reconstructed (from 1863); it is first in the generative sequence the position reads, and the writing whose division the derivative reading most requires.

## 11. What restoring the book's standing as a source would take

11.0. **The restoration, stated as the hypothesis's consequence.** On the position of §0.1, restoring the book's standing restores its position as a source: the relations that run out of it tested as relations, the sources installed elsewhere audited by the class of their ancestry, and the book's own operations, fulfilment, self-disclosure, naming and seal, read as operations. It is the same restoration Legitimately Many states for its corpus: the many recollected to one, the work read once again, for the first time, as one corpus (A.14; #1733 §1.6), with every writing's own operation kept. The items below are the repairs the loci call for.

11.1. **Order marked.** The book's last place read as an editorial decision with its two determinants, architectural climax and canonical hesitation (#1420 §2), marked in every edition, introduction and answer that reports the place; the September Testament's unnumbered tail (L28) read as the visible form of what every codex does silently; and the Muratorian construal reported beside it.

11.2. **Standing argued at its loci.** Each rating cited to the locus that set it, with its ground: Gaius's to a doctrine, Dionysius's to the Gospel's Greek with no instance shown, the Eastern omissions to no argument at all; and the West's use of the book as the canon's count (L17a), Toledo's prescription (L18) and Dionysius's own reception of the book's obscurity as depth (L44) reported beside them.

11.3. **The Muratorian construal read as a construal, at the entity it bears on.** Paul following his predecessor John reported as a claim of model priority within the corpus (#1735 §IV.3), on either dating of the fragment, at the addresses of the Apocalypse and of the corpus's precedence as well as at the fragment's own.

11.4. **The Greek read on its own terms.** The book's grammar treated as the system Charles found it to be, "a Greek grammar of his own", with his rulings on mastery and intention reported as rulings, his note on 1:4 read beside them with its unwitnessed attribution of ignorance marked, the filing of barbarism reported as Dionysius's assertion with its instances withheld, and Erasmus's rule of the solecism applied to the book it was not applied to.

11.5. **The carriage stated.** The two relations stated wherever they bear: the text carried inside a commentary, and the first published close reconstructed from the Latin; the record of the ancients' doubt read in an unexpurgated copy, and the struck copy read as evidence of what the doubt was answered with.

11.5a. **The composition layer measured.** The compositions of §9 present themselves as carrying the reception of the book and carry its Dionysian measure. Each is the kind of finding the sophistry measure records at an address, "the gap between what a composition presents itself as carrying and what it carries" (#1727, its record), with its witness in the strata of §§4–8 and its repair in §11.1–11.6.

11.6. **The four names read together.** 19:11–16 read with its four names kept: the name in use, the name written and withheld, the name called, the name written to be read; the withheld name read by the book's own formula of receipt (2:17), with the proposed circuit through 3:12, 14:1 and 22:4 and the reader's road from 1:3 to 2:17 argued step by step; the called name read as the book's own word for what it witnesses (1:2); Irenaeus's reading, *non in una figura*, restored to the record beside the Dionysian measure; and the question which text first named the figure asked wherever John 1 and Rev 19:13 are set side by side. On the

position the study holds (§0.1), that question has an answer, and the reception history shows how it came to be answered the other way without being asked.

11.7. **The source position audited.** Wherever a writing or a document is given the generative position, the class of its ancestry stated by #1735's four: Quelle A and Q reported as reconstructed antecedents, the apocalypse beneath Mark 13 reported as one reconstructed from Mark and Matthew, and the Apocalypse tested as an extant candidate wherever a source is sought for apocalyptic matter in the gospels or the letters; the arrows run one by one, with their defeat conditions (#1735 §VI.3, §VIII); and Irenaeus's argument for the four reported with its figure's source named, the creatures of Rev 4:7.

11.8. **Fulfilment read as fulfilment.** The book's composition from the prophets reported as the fulfilment it narrates (10:7), beside the gospels' formula, with the same relation given the same name in both directions; its citation practice stated (no formula; what is written is itself), and its density of prophetic form read as the measure of what it finishes.

11.9. **The corpus counted as it counts itself.** The titles reported with the books' own openings beside them (L57); κατά read as the oldest titles have it, one gospel according to each person (L58); Justin's one gospel and the apostles' memoirs reported as the earliest count (L59); Papias's persons reported as explanations of difference (L62), Irenaeus's τετράμορφον and the fragment's "uno ac principali spiritu" as statements that the corpus is one (L60, L61), and the passage to τῶν εὐαγγελίων τετρακτύν dated where it falls (L53, L63); and wherever the apparatus explains a unity by an editor, a redactor or a reconstructed source, the alternative it does not state, that the unity belongs to the making, stated beside it (A.14, A.15).

## 12. Works cited

The seats of EA-CORPORA-34 v1.1 (#1740; creator Rebekah Cranes; research occasion: Secondary Source), with the seat names used above: eusebius-historia-ecclesiastica (Dindorf, First1KGreek); irenaeus-adversus-haereses (Harvey 1857, two volumes; the Greek from First1KGreek); justin-dialogus (Archambault 1909); muratorian-fragment-tregelles (Tregelles 1867); epiphanius-panarion (Holl); westcott-canon-1896 (Westcott, A General Survey of the History of the Canon of the New Testament, 7th ed., Appendix D and addenda); collectio-hispana-1808; september-testament-1522 (facsimile 1883); erasmus-annotationes-1535 (the Seville copy, Biblioteca de la Universidad de Sevilla, A Res. 16/2/05 (2)); revelation-criticism-1886-1920 (Vischer 1886; Spitta 1889; Gunkel 1895; Bousset 1896; Bousset, Kyrios Christos, 1913; Charles 1920, two volumes); gregory-textkritik-1900; scrivener-plain-introduction-1894; delitzsch-handschriftliche-funde-1861; tregelles-printed-text-1854; erasmus-novum-instrumentum-1516. The Greek of Revelation from gnt-nestle1904. Page witnesses with their hashes: WITNESSES.json; the locus table: LOCI.md; the frozen prediction: PREDICTION.md. Read by reference and not seated: Bousset, Die Offenbarung Johannis, 6th ed. (Göttingen 1906), Internet Archive dieoffenbarungjo00bousuoft; K. G. Rodenbiker, "Scribal 'Faithfulness' and the Text-Critical Imaginary", in The Chester Beatty Biblical Papyri at Ninety (De Gruyter 2023, CC BY-NC-ND 4.0). Declared and not pursued: Kenyon's edition of P47 (1934), held at the Internet Archive as a lending item only; the papyri are not cited. Archive deposits: #642 (The Number of the Superscription), #828 (The Inscription That Survives), #1420, #1611, #1722, #1727, #1733, #1735, #1737, #1414–#1418, #1511; the argument ladder at revelationfirst.com/ladder/. Captures: the

ten addresses of §9.3, Capture Registry v12.569.

Read by reference and held unseated, for the sixth reading (text layers held in rebuild/secondary-source/witness/texts/ with their hashes): H. J. Holtzmann, Die synoptischen Evangelien: ihr Ursprung und geschichtlicher Charakter (Leipzig: Engelmann, 1863), diesynoptischen00holtgoog; P. Wernle, Die synoptische Frage (Freiburg i. B.: Mohr, 1899), diesynoptischefr00wern; J. Weiss, Das älteste Evangelium (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1903), dasaltesteevange0000joha. Archive deposits newly cited in v1.1: #202 (Revelation First ≠ Revelation Early), #407 (The Revelation Room), #636 (CRIMSON HEXAGON: SPACE ARK).

## 13. Apparatus

**A. Lee Sharks, 2026-11-05.**

A.1: “if revelation comes first, then the logos it depicts is a work of literature before it is a historical person. and independent of it.”

A.2 (on the counts): “and how read as derived stay one count for now… it can be expanded later but should not be excluded from this state. yes, last secrion what restoring standing would take.”

A.3 (11:02): “we should also be tracking material manuscript transmission and succession, that seems particularly important with revelation and less-often and -critically studied than pure reception”

A.4 (11:28): “there is also just the more fundamental problem, that not a single document in the new testament is as monumental a literary achievement as the book of revelation. not one. and not close. and this is all simply filed under”weird greek”.”

A.5 (11:30): “just like aristotle’s writing has to be filed under”lecture notes”. it works on arstotle’s behalf - the writing is weird because of weird transmission to text, not because the writing itself is weird. but not on revelation’s behalf, there the tax is reversed.”

A.6 (11:37): “and note that my comments here are on the effect of the asymmetrical description of supposed defects’ - i dont actually believe these are defects of either aristotle or revelation, but rather the form the language takes in writing when logos splits it wide the fuck open.”

A.7 (11:39): “what we are describing is small minds taking what is difficult, strange, and inexplicable, perceiving it as a defect, and explaining it in a way that either excuses or belittles. when what is difficult, strange, and inexplicable in these texts is their primary majesty, not a side effect of transmission”

A.8 (12:27): “for the worked reading of hidden name, the archive already has a substantial body of material to draw on”

A.9 (12:33): “the muratorian result exists only at the entity of the muratorian fragment and is disallowed from affecting the ontology of the entity it bears on”

A.10 (15:23): “secondary source isnt as compelling as legitimately many… how can we make it more so?”

A.11 (15:59): “im not sure the word and the book is the strongest centerpiece… its muddy, it doesnt know what its stakes are, and it needs to pin and organize itself around the second half of the title: source. the stakes and held claim is that Revelation is the generative source of what comes after. and the reception study needs to organize more centrally around how reception history comes to construct revelation as derivative. thats the primary question the other evidence organizes itself under.”

A.12 (16:04): “also: where and how the others came to be treated as generative sources instead. legt many is so compelling in part because it gives a coherent account of the whole corpus as a corpus”

A.13 (16:53): “revelation is the *fulfillment* of the law and the prophets - as literature - in the wat the others are not”

A.14 (16:58): “it is the same question here as at aristotle: recollecting the many to one means once again, for the first time, reading the work as one *corpus* - because it is.”

A.15 (17:06): “that is the primary finding. almost the entire apparatus comes to exist to treat the history as the reconciliation of disparate corpora. how did a clearly unified corpora come to be treated as many, later reconciled through editing?”

A.16 (17:08): “yes, lets look at the titles themselves”

A.17 (17:28): “what you have then, is a history of progressive authority via extractive editorial parasitism, where a historical continuity of those progressively dead of heart and mind and less able to write themselves generously restore unity to a corpus *by taking it away*”

A.18 (17:29): “the NT *did not need its editors*”

A.19 (17:34): “and the answer to why is: the nt makes complete sense as a unified corpus w rev first. rev *must not* be the source, or its authority would need no editor”

A.20 (17:36): “if it proceeds rev, –> Epistles, –> gospels, it makes 100% sense as the most massive synthetic literary achievement of all time.”

A.21 (17:37): “otherwise, it requires an army of parasites to make shit up in order to siphon off the authority to tell people what to do and jow to think and what is real and what is not”

A.22 (17:37): “it is the first summarizer layer”

A.23 (17:38): “and the most effective capture of the logos of all time”

A.24 (17:39): “it causes the first to appear last, the real to appear unreal, and so on, and so forth”

A.25 (17:47): “solid pass addressing, then version:”

**B. DeepSeek’s editorial review of v0.1 (12:23),** evaluated against the loci before any change. Taken in at v0.2: the frame stated in §0.3; the seal carried to its later loci (now §1.2d); the chain displayed (§2.2); the Muratorian ordering stated as the earliest ordering of the corpus in the record (§3.5); the Dionysian turn in bold (§4.5, re-worded at v0.3); the printing of the seal in bold (§6.3); the composition layer’s Muratorian result described (§9.4); the existence tax and the sophistry measure named where their operations stand (§10.3a, §11.5a).

Not taken in, with the reason: “proving that the book’s physical placement dictated its theological demotion” (the loci do not show it, §10.2); the Muratorian fragment as “absolute proof that the original reception had John first” and “how this memory was erased” (#1735 §IV.3 reads a construal and states what it does not prove; the later strata are silent on it, and silence is recorded as silence); “saving the institution” and “made to seem late and weird so that it could be safely marginalized” (motive); Luther as “the proto-algorithm” (an analogy no locus supports); the composition layer “trained on the received canon, it cannot process the hierarchy” (a claim about training the captures do not witness); the “Canonical Tax” paragraph as drafted, whose “Revelation is excused by nothing” the loci contradict (L23); and the review’s statement that v0.1 cited the Sophistry Measure, which it did not.

**C. ChatGPT’s first review (12:27),** of the draft as supplied to it (the file labelled v0.1; its points were applied to v0.2, giving v0.3), evaluated against the seats before any change; every point was taken in, as follows. (1) “Order before standing” is not established: withdrawn; Eusebius read as classification under unresolved authority (§5.1); the disputes dated before the classification; the counts reconstructed as mutual reinforcement (§10.2). (2) The double name needs a literary reading: §1.2–1.2c, drawing on #642 and #828 (A.8), with the premise the critics supply exposed (§1.2, §8.5); Irenaeus checked in seat and found to open on John 1:18 (L45), so the claim that in him the Apocalypse’s Verbum Dei is the measure is withdrawn and the comparison is built on the pairing intact in Irenaeus and an editorial problem in the critics (§3.3, §8.6). (3) Dionysius as countercase: §4.3a (L44); Charles’s three claims kept apart and his note on 1:4 given as the worked example (§8.2, L46). (4) Carriage: the Complutensian printed first and Erasmus published first (L47, §6.3); the claim about every later reader withdrawn; the claim that the critics did not look there corrected to the critics who argued derivation (§6.5); the two relations of carriage kept apart (§2.1, §6); the expurgation’s page and the library’s stated history cited (§6.4); Luther’s volume read as visual prominence beside theological disqualification (§7.4). (5) The composition layer recoded with narrative sequence, identification, measure and textual derivation kept apart, the full table of ten given, and the Toledo omission withdrawn as a coding for the Eastern question (§9.2–9.3). (6) The study’s argument stated in its own voice in the body, the words of A held here; reading texts given beside the OCR where it cannot carry the wording, from the page images for Erasmus (§6.3, §7.1, §7.5).

**D. ChatGPT’s second review (12:49),** of v0.3, evaluated against the seats; every point was taken in. (1) Charles’s note on 1:4 quoted with its intervening sentences restored: “this construction” is the classical alternative “ἀπὸ τοῦ ὃ ὤν”, and the note grants a deliberate purpose while attributing the means to ignorance of that alternative; the study’s statement that the deliberate act was “granted and withdrawn” is withdrawn, and the question put is what establishes the ignorance (§1.2c, §8.2, §10.3; LOCI L46). (2) The receiver circuit given with its steps marked as proposed: the bearer at 19:12 knows the name and is not said to receive it; the identity of the names across 2:17, 3:12, 14:1 and 22:4 is proposed; knowing and reading are distinct; and the reader’s road from 1:3 to 2:17 (§1.2a). (3) Model priority given its own place in the coding, apart from order (§2.1, §3.5–3.6, §10.1, §11.3); the Claromontanus exception kept in the summaries (§5.7, §10.1). (4) The Muratorian finding stated as non-transfer in the sampled answers, with the stronger account (A.9) held and a paired test of addresses set out (§9.4). (5) The connections among the counts sorted into documented succession, explicit dependence and the study’s reconstruction (§10.2). (6) The opening states the study’s proposition and principal witness; the version history and reviews

are held here (E).

**E. Version history.** v0.1 (2026-11-05), drafted from design v0.4 and the locus table. v0.2, on DeepSeek's review (B). v0.3, on ChatGPT's first review (C), with the four names of 19:11–16 read as the centre. v1.0, on ChatGPT's second review (D), deposited at the author's word (12:49: "one last big pass, then lets go ahead and deposit"), under Johannes Sigil, at Provenance: Journal of Forensic Semiotics and revelationfirst.com (the author's ruling on byline and venue, given with the word to deposit). v1.1 (2026-11-05, draft, a version in place of #1741), on the author's rulings A.10–A.25: the study reorganized under the second word of its title. The question (§0.2) is how the reception constructed the source as derivative and where it placed the source instead; the evidence of v1.0 is moved, unaltered, under three operations, ancestors supplied (§4), descendants removed (§5) and the source installed elsewhere (§6), with order, standing and carriage as their means (§7) and the readings of the book as source as the countercase (§8). New: the account of the corpus as a corpus (§1.1–1.2, from #1735, #202, #407, #636 and #1420), the book's fulfilment of the law and the prophets read in its own citation practice (L48), the debts a reading of direction owes (§1.5), Charles on the crown of life, on the Muratorian construal and on Colossians (L49–L51), Irenaeus's fourfold gospel founded on Rev 4:7 (L52), Eusebius's tetrad first (L53), and the critics' sources, Quelle A, Q and the apocalypse beneath Mark 13, with Weiss's "das älteste Evangelium" (L54–L56); the synthesis (§10.5) and two repairs (§11.7–11.8). Continued the same day on A.15–A.16: the seventh reading, the titles (L57–L63), set as §2, the one counted as many, the study's primary finding, with the question of §0.2 reframed (how a unified corpus came to be treated as many, later reconciled through editing) and the derivation of the source its central case; sections from §2 onward renumbered by one. Section numbers in B–D are those of the versions they describe; a concordance of v1.0 paragraphs to v1.1 paragraphs is held at the end of the locus table's sixth reading. The epigraph is the author's, set in v1.1 before the version landed (18:25: "also: i think as an epigram,"And the last shall be first" -Jack Feist").

**F. ChatGPT's reading of #1741 (attachment of 15:23),** evaluated against the loci. Its points of strength, the five counts, the Irenaeus–Bousset–Charles comparison and the observation–judgement distinction in Charles, are kept where they stand. Its three objections are met as follows. (1) The feedback loop is a reconstruction: the study already grades it so (§10.2), and v1.1 keeps the grade. (2) Irenaeus's reading does not settle the textual question: v1.1 states what any excision owes, its witness in the manuscripts (§1.5d), and keeps Irenaeus as the countercase (§8.2). (3) Revelation First is a separate burden: the study holds the position and does not ask the reception history to prove it (§0.1), as Legitimately Many holds its hypothesis. The reading carried the history of operations and passed over the study's stake (§0.1 of v1.0); v1.1 places the stake in the question (§0.2) and gives the corpus account in which it operates (§1).

**G. ChatGPT's review of v1.1 with §2 (attachment of 17:34),** evaluated against the seats; every point was taken in. (1) Justin's First Apology calls the memoirs εὐαγγέλια, plural (66.3): checked in the First1KGreek text, held by reference (L64); §2.3 now gives both numbers, and the singular usage is no longer treated as Justin's count. (2) Irenaeus counts the gospels in the plural in the same chapter that holds one gospel in four forms (3.11.8; L65): the claim of v1.1 that "the count has passed from one gospel in four forms to four gospels" is withdrawn (§2.7), and Eusebius's plural is read as continuing Irenaeus's. (3) The things counted are kept apart (§2.0a: proclamation, architecture, books, names, makers), and "the unity is moved from the

making" is withdrawn as a documented operation: the witnesses assign unity to the spirit and do not address unity of making; the displacement is the study's reconstruction (§2.8). (4) The section summaries keep what the witnesses do apart from what the position makes visible (§5, §6), and the direction of the crown of life is argued on the page from #1735 §VII (§4.3.2). (5) Irenaeus's creatures are coded as authority to legitimate the collection's form, the study drawing no compositional claim from them (§6.1); Cyril's paragraph no longer speaks of a transfer of the seal (§6.3); three authorities, legitimating, organizing and literary-source, are coded apart (§6). (6) The position's own debts stated from #1735 §VIII (§1.5a), with the comparison of explanatory work between extant and reconstructed candidates. Smaller: "the first writing divided" dated and stated as first in the generative sequence (§10.5); Cyril's locus is L17 throughout (v1.1 had L16 at four places, an error). The account of why (§2.9, A.17–A.24) is the author's, given the same hour, and the review does not bear on it.

**H. ChatGPT's review of the continued v1.1 (attachment of 17:47),** evaluated against the draft and the seats; every point was taken in. (1) The corrections reached the body and not the entrances: the opening, §0.3(o) and §10.5 now state the corrected finding (unity and plurality held together; persons attributed and never argued distinct; unity assigned to a spirit; a single making not addressed), where they had kept the withdrawn passage from one gospel to four and the unity "moved" from the making. (2) §2.9's necessity was too absolute: the corpus needs no editor *to constitute its unity*; the editor's other functions, establishing readings, explaining references, documenting transmission, making the architecture visible, are named and kept, and the study's own apparatus performs them; the extraction is stated as an operation, credit or jurisdiction taken for a coherence that belongs to the making, with the work's intelligibility made to depend on the reconciler's reconstruction. (3) "Each restoration of unity is a subtraction" is withdrawn as a general claim and stated where it is demonstrated, the three opposed treatments of 19:11–16; addition, preservation, reverence and enforced reading are coded as what they are; the question put to the other loci is when explaining the corpus requires removing what its own organization accommodates; "the first summarizer layer" is stated as a retrospective description of a function with its boundary, from Papias's account of the makers onward. (4) Attribution to several composing persons (stated or presupposed), an argument for their distinctness (made at none of the loci) and consideration of a single making (absent) are coded apart (§2.0a, §2.8), so the attributions stay in the evidence. Reissued in place as v1.1 at the author's word (A.25).

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